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The Formalized State

The Hierarchy of the Beast System

Part VII of *The Six Pillars of the Beast System*

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Abstract

The six-pillar framework identifies an invariant structure of human governance, supported by historical observation and given precise expression through mathematics. Every governance system decides who controls resources, makes and interprets rules, shapes beliefs, enforces and produces. This paper defines the Formalized State, a class of structures with six layers of control, a role map and a dependency hypergraph, and proves four results relative to stated axioms and a stated set of preserved properties: roles, control shares, concentration, contestability, integration and dependencies. Representation: every governance system satisfying the axioms is equivalent to a Formalized State structure; content, ideology and procedure are forgotten. Necessity: six axioms about collective life (scarcity, plurality, generality, coordination, defection and maintenance) force the six functions, each axiom can fail in a persistent model, and four incidence axioms with falsifiers make the functions fully interdependent, although interpretation needs legitimation or coercion rather than both. Minimality: dropping or merging any pillar identifies systems that differ in a preserved property, with explicit witness pairs. Uniqueness: the abstraction is the coarsest one preserving those properties, unique up to unique isomorphism, with exactly six dimensions. Encodings of Aristotle, Weber, Parsons, Easton, Almond, Luhmann and Mann each identify two systems the abstraction distinguishes, so none is equivalent to it. Capture is a property of instances: structures satisfying every axiom occupy all four corners of the concentration and integration square. The regime analyses rest on the historical and ethnographic record, and the indices are defined so that real polities can be scored quantitatively.

1 Introduction

Every governance system answers six questions. Who controls the resources? Who makes the laws? Who interprets the laws? Who shapes the beliefs? Who enforces the rules? Who produces the wealth that sustains everything? The answers range from a Ju/'hoansi camp talking a dispute out at night to a party committee that appoints judges, editors and generals. This paper argues that one mathematical structure represents all of these answers, that the structure is forced by premises about collective life that could be false, and that nothing in it implies that the answers are held by one coalition beyond review.

The organizing claim of the series is that the six-pillar framework identifies an invariant structure of human governance, supported by historical observation and given precise expression through mathematics. Each part of the claim has a specific home. The invariant structure is the Formalized State: Theorem 7.4 shows that every governance system satisfying the axioms is represented by it, and Theorems 7.7 and 7.8 show that it is invariant across all of them up to $\cong_A$ and unique for the properties it preserves. The historical observation is the comparison of six regime types in Parts I to VI, the minimal forms of the stateless societies in Table 2, and the falsifiable hypotheses of Table 4. The mathematics is the axioms, the theorems, and the reference implementation mapped in Section A. Historical observation supports the axioms; it does not prove them. The theorems are proofs relative to the axioms, and the axioms remain open to the falsifiers stated with each of them.

The paper is the seventh and last Part of a series that adopts the vocabulary and the multiplex-network model of Largo (2026). The source paper named the configuration the Hierarchy of the Beast System after the imagery of Revelation 13 and used five functions. The series splits the source's legal-administrative function into rule making and interpretation and treats the resulting six pillars in Parts I to VI: control of resources (F), rule making (P), interpretation (J), legitimation (I), coercion (C) and production (W) (Long, 2026b,e,d,c,a,f). In the series, the name "Beast System" is the typological, theological reading of the universal structure. It is not a mathematical conclusion about the moral character of any government, and it never labels a religion, a people, a profession, a regime or a person.

The Formalized State is an abstraction, not a form of government. Definition 7.1 defines it as a class $\mathcal{F}$ of structures: six layers of control over a set of actors, a many-to-many role map, control shares, contestability and coalition data, and a dependency hypergraph that is strongly connected and cascade-complete. Theorem 7.4 proves that every governance system satisfying the axioms is equivalent to a member of $\mathcal{F}$ under a relation $\cong_A$ that preserves roles, shares, concentration, contestability, integration and dependencies, and forgets the content of rules, beliefs and procedures. The class of governance systems is defined without reference to the six functions (Definition 2.1), so the theorem can fail, and Section 7 exhibits collectives for which it does.

Four results are kept distinct. Representation says that every governance system is an instance of the abstraction. Necessity says why: the properties that membership in $\mathcal{F}$ requires follow from axioms. Theorem 4.3 derives the six functions from six axioms, assembling the pillar-level results of Parts I to VI under one persistence condition, and Proposition 4.4 shows that each axiom can fail in a persistent model in which its function is absent. Theorem 5.10 derives full interdependence from four further incidence axioms with falsifiers, using a directed hypergraph because interpretation depends on legitimation or on coercion and not necessarily both (Proposition 3.6 of Part III). Minimality says that the abstraction cannot be made coarser: Proposition 7.5 exhibits, for every way of dropping or merging pillars, two governance systems that the coarser abstraction confuses. Uniqueness says that the abstraction is the coarsest one that preserves the stated properties, unique up to a unique isomorphism, and that it has exactly six dimensions (Theorems 7.7 and 7.8). All four results are relative to the axioms and to the preserved properties. Theorem 10.2 then shows that encodings of seven classical frameworks, from Aristotle to Mann, each fail to distinguish a pair of systems that the Formalized State distinguishes.

The series keeps two propositions apart. Proposition A states that every functioning governance system contains the six functions and the dependencies among them; in the language of this paper it is the representation theorem. Proposition B states that in some systems the functions become concentrated and coordinated so that independent

accountability fails. Concentration, capture, autonomy and accountability are properties of instances, measured by U_t, $\mathcal{I}_t$ and capture links, and they are not conditions of membership. Theorem 6.6 shows that structures satisfying every axiom occupy all four corners of the concentration and integration square, and Theorem 8.5 gives conditions under which a coalition's foothold in several pillars dies out or persists. The six regime types of the series are implementations of the abstraction that differ in where integration concentrates and what checks it.

2 The six-layer model

2.1 Shared objects

The formal objects come from Largo (2026), and the series uses them without redefinition. A polity at time t is a directed multiplex network $G_t = (V_t, E_t)$ whose nodes are organizations or coherent actor groups. Each pillar $m \in \mathcal{M} = \{\mathsf{F}, \mathsf{P}, \mathsf{J}, \mathsf{I}, \mathsf{C}, \mathsf{W}\}$, with $M = |\mathcal{M}| = 6$, has a layer with adjacency A_t^m and edge weights $a_{ij,t}^m \in [0,1]$, the documented capacity of actor i to constrain a feasible action of actor j through mechanism m. A role map assigns actors to pillars, many to many. Actor i holds a control share $s_{i,t}^m$ in pillar m, with $\sum_i s_{i,t}^m = 1$, and concentration is the Herfindahl index $H_{m,t} = \sum_i (s_{i,t}^m)^2$. The multiplex formalism follows the standard treatment of multilayer networks (Kivela et al., 2014).

Contestability $Q_{m,t} \in [0,1]$ summarizes transparency, appeal rights, independence, competition and credible replacement. Unaccountable concentration is the illustrative index $U_t = \sum_m \omega_m H_{m,t}(1 - Q_{m,t})$ with nonnegative preregistered weights that sum to one. Cross-pillar integration $C_{mn,t} \in [0,1]$ is the extent to which one coalition commands appointments, budgets, sanctions or agenda in both m and n, and the integration statistic is

$$\mathcal{I}_t = \frac{2}{M(M-1)} \sum_{m<n} C_{mn,t},$$

the mean over the fifteen pairs. A capture link $(i \to j, m)$ requires privileged access or discretion, a weakening of applicable accountability or contestability, and material evidence that ties the asymmetry to an institutional output. The source's strong classification requires both high U_t and high $\mathcal{I}_t$ (Largo, 2026). The aggregate capacities $x_t = (\mathsf{F}_t, \mathsf{P}_t, \mathsf{J}_t, \mathsf{I}_t^{\text{cap}}, \mathsf{C}_t, \mathsf{W}_t)$ follow $x_{t+1} = B_t x_t + D_t z_t + \varepsilon_t$, where B_t collects dependencies, z_t external shocks and ε_t unobserved influences.

Three notational collisions need a convention. The integration statistic is written $\mathcal{I}_t$ and the legitimation pillar I. The source's role map is not written F, since F is the resource pillar. The series' central statement writes the structural predicate of Proposition A as $B(G)$; this paper writes it $\mathsf{Struct}(G)$, so that it cannot be confused with the dynamics matrix B_t or with Proposition B.

2.2 Functions as classes of practices

A function is defined by the problem it solves, not by the institution that solves it. This is the distinction that Hempel (1959) required of functional analysis and that Merton (1968) called the problem of functional alternatives: from the need for a function nothing follows about which institution meets it. Each pillar Part fixed a problem and a class of practices that solve it. The present section fixes a common frame in which the six results can be combined.

Definition 2.1 (Collective, functioning and persistence)**.** A *collective* G is the largest group whose members make collective decisions as one body, so that a member's move between subgroups of G is not exit from G; formally, G is a set N_t of at least two human members at each date $t = 1, 2, \ldots$, a rule system R_t, and a probability space $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, \Pr)$ with a filtration $(\mathcal{F}_t)$ that records its history. G *functions* at date t if members make collective decisions and comply with R_t and recognize its office holders often enough for those decisions to be carried out, and if the stock that sustains the collective is nonnegative. The *persistence event* is $\Pi = \{G \text{ functions at every date}\}$. G is *persistent* if $\Pr(\Pi) > 0$. The class $\mathcal{G}$ of functioning governance systems is the class of persistent human collectives.

The definition of $\mathcal{G}$ mentions collective decisions, rules and compliance. It does not mention allocation, rule making, interpretation, legitimation, sanction or production. A collective in which nobody settled conflicting claims, nobody determined disputes and nobody produced anything would still belong to $\mathcal{G}$ if it persisted. Proposition A says that such a collective does not persist, and that is a substantive claim.

Definition 2.2 (Implementation)**.** For each pillar m, the predicate $\mathsf{Impl}_m(G)$ is the conclusion of the pillar's necessity result, stated in that Part's vocabulary:

(i) $\mathsf{Impl}_{\mathsf{F}}$: almost surely on Π, only finitely many conflicts over goods are unsettled and infinitely many are settled by a procedure in the collective's repertoire (Definitions 2.1 and 2.2 of Part I);

(ii) $\mathsf{Impl}_{\mathsf{P}}$: on Π, every collective decision is produced by a practice of the members that selects among alternatives over which their preferences diverge (Definition 2.2(a) of Part II);

(iii) $\mathsf{Impl}_{\mathsf{J}}$: almost surely on Π, infinitely many residual disputes are disposed of by determination, a procedure that neither party controls alone and on which both act (Definitions 2.2 and 2.3 of Part III);

(iv) $\mathsf{Impl}_{\mathsf{I}}$: on Π, in every window of length L some practice refines members' information so that the rule system in force becomes common knowledge among the cooperating members (Definition 2.1 and Theorem 3.5 of Part IV);

(v) $\mathsf{Impl}_{\mathsf{C}}$: the sanction regime of the strategy profile in force is nontrivial, with a long-run share of at least $(p - \theta)/p$ of agent-periods facing a strictly positive deterrence margin (Theorem 3.4 of Part V);

(vi) $\mathsf{Impl}_{\mathsf{W}}$: on Π, productive activity occurs in infinitely many periods and the long-run average inflow is at least the per-period consumption $k > 0$ (Lemma 3.3 of Part VI).

Each predicate is a property of observable dispositions: counts of settled and unsettled conflicts, the procedures that produced decisions and determinations, the information of entrants, the responses that violations meet, and the flows that replenish the collective's stock. None is satisfied by naming an office. A predicate can fail in a persistent collective, and Proposition 4.4 constructs such collectives.

Definition 2.3 (Structural predicate)**.** $\mathsf{Struct}(G)$ holds if $\mathsf{Impl}_m(G)$ holds for every $m \in \mathcal{M}$ and the dependency relations $\mathcal{D}_0$ of Lemma 5.4 hold in G. Proposition A is the statement that $\mathsf{Struct}(G)$ and the interdependence predicate $\mathsf{Inter}(G)$ of Definition 5.2 hold for every $G \in \mathcal{G}$.

The functions may be distributed across many institutions, fused inside one, or exercised informally. $\mathsf{Struct}(G)$ is silent on these alternatives, because it is a statement about the support of the role map and not about the values of H, Q or C.

3 Axioms

The series works from six axioms about collective life. In their informal versions they are short: resources are finite and claims on them conflict (Ax1, scarcity); members' preferences diverge and collective choices are made (Ax2, plurality); rules are general, cases particular, and disputes arise (Ax3, generality); cooperation requires shared knowledge of the rules (Ax4, coordination); some members sometimes break rules (Ax5, defection); and the group and its institutions consume resources that someone produces (Ax6, maintenance). The informal versions are too weak to carry a proof, and each pillar Part supplied the auxiliary assumptions its derivation needed. The refined axiom Axk^* is the bundle that the Part actually used. Table 1 records the bundles.

The refined axioms are empirical claims about human collectives, not logical truths. Each can be false of some conceivable collective. A population that consumed nothing would violate Ax6*; a population of agents who never wished to break a rule would violate Ax5*; a collective whose members agreed about every collective choice would violate Ax2*; a colony whose rules were fixed by development, as in social insects, would violate the non-innateness clause of Ax4*. The hazard clauses of Ax1* and Ax3* are the most demanding, and the pillar Parts identified the cases that test them: collectives in which unsettled conflict is costless (Part I, Section 3) and collectives in which every residual dispute, including disputes among co-resident kin and over rights that follow the parties, can be escaped by free exit (Proposition 3.4 of Part III). Where a premise fails, the derivation of the corresponding function does not apply, and the presence of the function rests on the ethnographic record alone.

Proposition A as the series states it therefore has two parts. The deductive part is a theorem: a collective that satisfies the refined axioms and persists implements every function. The empirical part is the bridge hypothesis that every functioning human collective satisfies the refined axioms. Part V states the bridge for its own axiom as an explicit assumption (Assumption 3.2 of Part V); the same structure holds for the other five. The honest content of a proof from minimal axioms is a valid derivation together with a list of the premises that could be false.

4 Structural necessity

4.1 The forcing lemma

Two of the six pillar results share a single argument, which can be stated once. A recurring problem is forced if leaving an instance unsolved carries a bounded-below risk of ending the collective.

Lemma 4.1 (Forcing)**.** *Let a collective face a sequence of problem instances, indexed in order of disposition, each disposed of as solved or unsolved at a finite time. Suppose there is $\kappa \in (0, 1]$ such that, conditional on the history up to the disposition of any instance and on that instance being unsolved, functioning ends at the disposition with probability at least κ. Let N be the number of unsolved instances, with $N = \infty$ allowed. Then*

Table 1: The refined axioms. Each refined axiom is the set of assumptions under which the cited pillar result was proved; the right column names the result.

Axiom	Refined content	Pillar result
Ax1* scarcity	While the collective exists, a conflict over goods occurs in each period with conditional probability at least $p > 0$, and an unsettled conflict ends functioning with conditional probability at least $q > 0$	Proposition 3.3 of Part I
Ax2* plurality	Collective decisions recur, members' preferences diverge over every decision's alternatives, and decisions and rule changes are produced by the members' own practices	Theorem 3.7 of Part II
Ax3* generality	On the persistence event infinitely many residual disputes arise that a move to another group of the collective does not escape (disputes among co-resident kin, or over rights to territory, water or sharing that follow the parties wherever they move); each reaches a disposition at a finite time; for these disputes a disposition by self-help, exit or abandonment ends functioning with conditional probability at least $\kappa > 0$; and a losing party complies with a determination if and only if the value it places on the procedure's legitimacy plus the expected sanction is at least its gain from defiance, where the value is positive only if some practice of the legitimation class (Definition 2.1 of Part IV) has led the party to regard the procedure as rightful, and the expected sanction is positive only if some agent's practice answers defiance with a sanction	Theorem 3.3 and Proposition 3.6 of Part III
Ax4* coordination	When the collective functions, its rule system, including its settlement procedures, is common knowledge among a cooperating core, members turn over within a bounded horizon L, entrants cannot infer the rules from innate endowment, members do not forget what they learn, and entrants are parties to conflicts over goods in infinitely many periods	Theorem 3.5 of Part IV
Ax5* defection	Some rule in force has a share p of agents tempted to violate it in the absence of any response that exceeds the violation rate θ the collective can tolerate, and members best-respond to the sanction regime in force (Lemma 3.3 of Part V)	Theorem 3.4 of Part V
Ax6* maintenance	The collective and its institutions consume at least $k > 0$ per period from a finite initial stock; inflows are produced by some agent's productive activity; and every practice of every pillar is performed by agents whose consumption is counted here, in a period only if that consumption is met	Lemma 3.3 of Part VI

(a) $\Pr(\Pi \cap \{N \geq n\}) \leq (1-\kappa)^n$ *for every* $n \geq 1$*, so* $N < \infty$ *almost surely on* Π*;*

(b) if infinitely many instances arise almost surely on Π*, then almost surely on* Π *infinitely many instances are solved, and the fraction of solved instances among the first* k *tends to one as* $k \to \infty$*.*

Proof. (a) For $n \geq 1$ let S_n be the event that at least n instances are left unsolved and the collective keeps functioning through the disposition of each of the first n. Conditional on S_{n-1} and on the occurrence of an n-th unsolved instance, functioning survives that disposition with probability at most $1-\kappa$, so $\Pr(S_n) \leq (1-\kappa)\Pr(S_{n-1})$, and induction from $\Pr(S_0) = 1$ gives $\Pr(S_n) \leq (1-\kappa)^n$. Since $\Pi \cap \{N \geq n\} \subseteq S_n$, the bound follows, and $\Pr(\Pi \cap \{N = \infty\}) \leq \inf_n (1-\kappa)^n = 0$.

(b) On Π, by (a), the number of unsolved instances among the first k is eventually constant, while by hypothesis k grows without bound. The number solved among the first k is k minus that constant, so it tends to infinity and its ratio to k tends to one. □

Part III proved its necessity theorem by this argument, with residual disputes as instances and determination as solution (Theorem 3.3 of Part III). Part I proved a quantitative version with conflicts over goods as instances and settlement as solution (Proposition 3.3 of Part I). The lemma does not say that the solutions are good ones. A collective may settle conflicts by rules that favor a few, and determine disputes by biased procedures, and still satisfy it.

4.2 Three patterns of argument

The six pillar results rest on three kinds of argument, and the difference matters for what would refute them. Hazard forcing, Lemma 4.1, gives the financial and judicial pillars; its empirical content is the hazard, and where unsolved instances are harmless, as with costless exit from a band, it gives nothing. Stock accounting gives the productive pillar: persistence requires a nonnegative stock $X_T = X_0 + \sum_{t<T}(Y_t - K_t^{\mathrm{tot}})$, so with consumption at least $k > 0$ and a finite initial stock the inflows must average at least k, and the no-manna assumption makes every inflow someone's productive activity, possibly an outsider's (Lemmas 3.3 and 3.4 of Part VI). Constitutive arguments give the rest. A decision that binds everyone over alternatives on which members disagree is a selection among divergent preferences (Lemma 3.4 of Part II). Members who enter without knowing the rules acquire common knowledge of them only through practices that refine their information (Theorem 3.5 of Part IV, following Lewis 1969 and Aumann 1976). And if more agents are tempted than the collective can tolerate, best responses keep violations within tolerance only if a positive deterrence margin shifts at least $p - \theta$ of probability mass to compliance (Theorem 3.4 of Part V, in the tradition of Becker 1968).

Lemma 4.2 (Pillar necessity)**.** *Let* G *be a collective with* $\Pr(\Pi) > 0$*. For each* $k = 1, \ldots, 6$*, if* G *satisfies Axk* then* $\mathsf{Impl}_{m_k}(G)$ *holds, where* $(m_1, \ldots, m_6) = (\mathsf{F}, \mathsf{P}, \mathsf{J}, \mathsf{I}, \mathsf{C}, \mathsf{W})$*.*

Proof. F: under Ax1*, Lemma 4.1(a) with $\kappa = q$ gives finitely many unsettled conflicts almost surely on Π. Part I's Proposition 3.3(b) gives $\Pr(\Pi \cap \{Y_T < pT/2\}) \leq e^{-pT/8}$ for the number Y_T of periods with a conflict up to T. The bounds are summable in T, so by the Borel-Cantelli lemma, almost surely on Π we have $Y_T \geq pT/2$ for all large T; conflicts therefore arise infinitely often on Π, and Lemma 4.1(b) gives infinitely many settled conflicts. P: on Π collective decisions are made, and Ax2* contains the hypotheses of Lemma 3.4 and Theorem 3.7 of Part II, which give sense (a) of Definition 2.2 of Part II at every decision. J:

Lemma 4.1(b), applied to the subsequence of residual disputes that a move does not escape, which Ax3* makes infinite and subject to the hazard κ, with determination as solution, gives infinitely many determinations almost surely on Π, which is Impl_J; Theorem 3.3 of Part III is the case in which every residual dispute is inescapable. I: on Π the collective functions at every date, so every window of length L lies in an interval of functioning longer than L, and Theorem 3.5 of Part IV applies to each window. C: Ax5* is Assumption 3.1 of Part V for a rule in force under a best-response profile, and Theorem 3.4 of Part V gives the stated bound. W: on Π the stock stays nonnegative at every date, which is persistence in the sense of Part VI, and Lemma 3.3 of Part VI applies. □

The lemma adds nothing to the six Parts except a common persistence event. That is its purpose. The Parts used different notions of persistence, from survival up to a horizon to functioning over a window, and a theorem about one collective needs one notion.

4.3 The structural necessity theorem

Theorem 4.3 (Structural necessity)**.** *Let G be a persistent collective that satisfies Ax1* to Ax6*. Then, almost surely on the persistence event, all six functions are implemented: $\mathsf{Impl}_m(G)$ holds for every $m \in \mathcal{M}$. If every functioning human collective satisfies the refined axioms, this holds for every $G \in \mathcal{G}$. Corollary 5.5 adds the dependency relations $\mathcal{D}_0$, which gives $\mathsf{Struct}(G)$, the first half of Proposition A.*

Universality over real governance systems is the theorem together with the empirical bridge that every functioning collective satisfies Ax1* to Ax6*, which historical observation supports.

Proof. By Lemma 4.2, each $\mathsf{Impl}_m(G)$ holds, either deterministically on Π or on an event of full conditional probability given Π. A finite intersection of events of full conditional probability has full conditional probability, so all six hold together almost surely on Π. The second sentence restates the first under the bridge hypothesis. □

The theorem does not use the integration statistic, the concentration indices, or any premise about who holds control. It also does not use strong connectivity of the dependency structure, which Section 5 derives from four further axioms. The second half of Proposition A, universal interdependence, is Theorem 5.10, and the two theorems together with the bridge hypothesis are Proposition A in the sense of the series.

4.4 Consistency and independence of the axioms

A theorem from axioms says little if the axioms have no model, and a necessity claim is empty if the conclusion holds whether or not the axioms do. The next proposition settles both points.

Proposition 4.4 (Consistency and independence)**.**

(a) There is a collective that functions at every date with probability one, satisfies Ax1 to Ax6*, and implements all six functions.*

(b) For each k there is a collective that functions at every date with probability one, satisfies Axj for every $j \neq k$, violates Axk*, and does not implement m_k.*

Proof. (a) Take three members at every date; the collective has no subgroups, so no residual dispute can be escaped by a move and every residual dispute is inescapable in the sense of Ax3*. One member is replaced by an entrant every L periods; the member replaced is always the longest-serving one, an entrant does not know the rule system at entry and no member forgets what it learns, and the plot is claimed in each period by the most recent entrant and one other member, so entrants are parties to conflicts over goods in every period. In each period: one plot of land is claimed by two members and is assigned by a known rotation rule, with hazard $q = 1/2$ attached to an unsettled conflict; the members choose between two campsites, with members 1 and 2 preferring different sites, by majority vote; one residual dispute about the application of a rule arises between two members and is determined by a lot drawn by the third, whose result both accept because each places on the procedure a value ℓ at least as large as its gain from defiance, a value acquired at the initiation described next, where the lot is presented as the rightful procedure, with hazard $\kappa = 1/2$ attached to any other disposition; an entrant takes part in a public initiation at which the rule system is recited to all members, which makes it common knowledge among those initiated; each member observes a temptation to breach a rule of camp chores, drawn from a distribution G with $p = 1 - G(0) = 1/2$, and a breach is met with a fine d paid to the other members, with d chosen so that $G(d) \geq 3/4$, members best-respond to the fine, and the collective tolerates a violation rate $\theta = 1/4$; and the members forage an output equal to their consumption k; each member forages alone, at any campsite. Every conflict is settled and every residual dispute determined, so no hazard is ever triggered and the collective functions at every date with probability one. Each refined axiom holds by construction, and each implementation predicate holds: settlement in every period, majority choice over divergent preferences, determination in every period, initiation in every window, a positive margin d for every agent at every date, and foraging in every period.

(b) Modify the model of (a) in one component. For $k = 1$, set $q = 0$ and assign the plot by contest each period, so conflicts are never settled and never harmful. For $k = 2$, give all members the same preference over campsites, so no decision selects among divergent preferences. For $k = 3$, abandon every residual dispute and set the hazard of abandonment to zero, which is the costless-exit case of Proposition 3.4 of Part III. For $k = 4$, let entrants know the rule system at entry, drop the initiation, and attach the fine $d \geq g$ to defiance of a determination, so no practice of the legitimation class operates and determinations rest on sanction alone. For $k = 5$, let temptations be nonpositive, so $p = 0 \leq \theta$, and remove the fine, so every margin is zero and no violation occurs. For $k = 6$, let an inflow of k arrive in every period with no productive act by anyone. In each case the modified component triggers no hazard, the other components are unchanged, and the stated axiom and predicate fail. □

Part (b) is the formal answer to the charge that Proposition A is true by definition. In each modified collective the function is absent and the collective persists, so the class of persistent collectives does not contain the six functions by construction. What excludes such collectives from the real world is the failure of their premises: harmless unsettled conflict, unanimous preferences, free exit, innate rules, untempted members and unproduced inflows. Those are empirical claims, and the pillar Parts tested each against the ethnographic and historical record.

4.5 Minimal forms

The hard cases for Proposition A are societies described as having no state, no chiefs with power to command, or radical equality. The series predicts that each implements every function in an informal and dispersed form. The prediction has a formal core.

Lemma 4.5 (Minimal form)**.** *Let a collective of $n \geq 2$ adults implement every function through practices without designated offices in which each adult holds an equal share of decision-relevant control, and let $Q_m \geq \bar{q}$ for every m. Then $H_m = 1/n$ for every m and $U_t \leq (1 - \bar{q})/n$. If the coalition of all adults is admissible in the coalition list that defines C_{mn} (Definition 6.1), then $C_{mn} = 1$ for every pair and $\mathcal{I}_t = 1$. In either case the capture predicate of Definition 6.3 fails for every threshold $u^* > (1 - \bar{q})/n$.*

Proof. Equal shares give $H_m = n \cdot (1/n)^2 = 1/n$. Then $U_t = \sum_m \omega_m (1/n)(1 - Q_m) \leq (1 - \bar{q})/n$. If the grand coalition $S = N$ is admissible, its control share in every pillar is one, so $\min\{\kappa_m(N), \kappa_n(N)\} = 1$ for every pair. The capture predicate requires $U_t \geq u^*$, which fails when $u^* > (1 - \bar{q})/n$. □

The lemma resolves an apparent paradox in the ethnography. In egalitarian bands the same body judges, sanctions, decides and legitimates, so integration is at its maximum (Part III observed that C_{JC} is high there), yet the functions are held equally and open to challenge by anyone, so unaccountable concentration is near its minimum. This is the clearest reason why the source requires both indices to be high: integration of functions in the group as a whole is the opposite of capture.

Table 2 collects the minimal forms that the pillar Parts documented for the Nuer (Evans-Pritchard, 1940), the Ju/'hoansi (Marshall, 1976; Lee, 1979, 2013; Wiessner, 2005), mobile foragers with a reverse dominance hierarchy (Boehm, 1999), Amazonian groups whose headmen speak but cannot command (Clastres, 1987), and Ostrom's long-enduring commons (Ostrom, 1990; Cox et al., 2010). Woodburn's institutions of leveling show the same pattern from the side of sanctions: egalitarianism is produced and defended, not given (Woodburn, 1982).

The table supports both halves of the series' thesis: every function operates where no office does, which is what Proposition A requires, and concentration varies with circumstance and choice, which is what makes Proposition B contingent. Some early societies moved seasonally between egalitarian and hierarchical arrangements, including temporary policing during collective hunts (Graeber and Wengrow, 2021); upland groups in Southeast Asia kept their functions dispersed to avoid incorporation into lowland states (Scott, 2009); and early grain states concentrated the resource and productive functions where taxable surpluses allowed (Scott, 2017). Two cautions qualify the record without removing any function from it. The ethnographies describe groups in marginal environments and in contact with states and markets, and foraging societies vary widely (Kelly, 1995). Equal formal shares understate actual concentration, because age, gender, skill and kinship give some speakers more weight (Part II, Section 3).

The Ju/'hoansi are the hardest case for the judicial derivation, because moving to another camp resolves many disputes with no third party (Part III, Section 3). Under the unit of Definition 2.1 the collective is the network of camps linked by kinship and exchange, within which a move is not exit. We code the Ju/'hoansi as satisfying the inescapable-dispute clause of Ax3*: rights to territory and water are held through kin and follow a person from camp to camp, and disputes over sharing and marriage among kin recur and are talked out

Table 2: Minimal forms of the six functions in stateless and consensus societies, as documented in Parts I to VI. Each cell names the practice; no cell names an office with power to command.

Case	F	P	J	I	C	W
Nuer	Cattle rights and bridewealth	Negotiation among lineages	Mediation by the leopard-skin chief	Lineage idiom and ritual	Threat of feud by kin	Herding and cultivation
Ju/'hoansi	Meat shared by the arrow-owner rule	Camp talk and moving camp	Talking disputes out	Talk heard by all and the healing dance	Criticism, ridicule and avoidance	Foraging by both sexes
Mobile foragers	Sharing enforced against hoarders	Group decision against would-be leaders	Group judgment of deviants	Shared moral talk	Ostracism, exile and execution	Foraging
Amazonian groups	The headman's duty of generosity	Consensus with oratory as duty	Peacemaking by the headman	Myth and the headman's recitation	Abandonment of a commanding headman	Gardening and hunting
Commons users	Appropriation and boundary rules	Users modify the rules	Low-cost local arenas	Rules known to users	Monitoring and graduated sanctions	Provision of maintenance labor

in public (Lee, 2013; Wiessner, 2005); Lee's records of homicide show that self-help between kin carried a real risk of feud (Lee, 1979), which we read as a hazard to the functioning of the camp network in the sense of Ax3*. The coding is an ethnographic reading of these sources, not a measurement of the hazard. With it and the codings of the other five axioms in Parts I to VI, the Ju/'hoansi are an instance of Theorem 4.3, with a thin but present judicial function.

4.6 Falsifiers and counterexample attempts

Each pillar Part identified its strongest counterexample attempt and the observation that would refute its result. Table 3 collects them. Every reply in the table narrows the claim in a stated direction or relocates the function; none rescues the claim by redefining the function after the fact.

The coercion row needs one further safeguard. The replies to internalization and exit could be used to reclassify any compliant collective without sanctions as one in which few members are tempted, which would make the necessity claim immune to evidence. Part V therefore requires that the temptation share be measured independently of the sanction practices it is used to explain, for example by offering members an unobserved opportunity to break a rule, and it states the falsifier without the tolerance θ, which would otherwise be an adjustable parameter. The same requirement applies to every hazard in Table 1 and to the legitimacy value and expected sanction in the compliance clause of Ax3*: a premise measured only through the outcome it is meant to explain cannot test anything.

Table 3: The strongest counterexample attempt for each pillar, the reply given in the pillar Part, and the observation that would refute the pillar's necessity result.

	Counterexample attempt	Reply	Falsifier
F	Foragers' wants are easily met, so there is no scarcity (Sahlins, 1972)	Scarcity concerns conflicting claims, and affluence lowers p without making it zero	A persistent collective whose members hold conflicting claims and resolve them mostly without any settlement procedure
P	Custom evolves without legislators (Hayek, 1973; Ellickson, 1991)	Distributed practices still select and change rules, with no office	A long-lived plural group whose rules never changed through environments that no single rule system could survive
J	Free exit, or rules executed by code	Free exit thins the function (Proposition 3.4 of Part III), and code relocates interpretation to the encoding of cases (Proposition 3.5 of Part III)	A persistent collective in which disputes that a move does not escape recur and are always settled by force or left open
I	Force alone coordinates	Sanctions deter only those who know them, and elites must coordinate on expectations	A collective with turnover and locally variable rules whose entrants coordinate without any practice that informs them
C	Reciprocity and reputation enforce without coercion (Axelrod, 1984; Greif, 1993)	Withdrawal of cooperation is a sanction	A rule whose measured temptation share exceeds its observed violation rate while violators fare no worse than matched compliers
W	Endowments, raiding, rents or automation	Production is relocated to donors, victims, extractors or the owners of machines (Lemma 3.4 of Part VI)	A system that persists indefinitely with no production anywhere and no replenishment of its stock

4.7 Hart's secondary rules

Hart argued that a regime of primary obligations alone suffers from uncertainty about which rules exist, a static character, and inefficiency in settling disputes, and that the remedies are a rule of recognition, rules of change and rules of adjudication (Hart, 1961). The series assigns these to legitimation, rule making and interpretation (Definition 3.6 of Part II, Definition 2.2 of Part IV, Section 2 of Part III), and draws the boundary between P and J by acts: making or changing a general rule belongs to P, applying a given rule to a case belongs to J (Definition 2.3 of Part II). A court that changes a rule by precedent performs both acts, and the role map records it in both layers. Under precedent, interpretation becomes an input to rule change and rule change produces the rules that interpretation applies, while recognition certifies both, since a new statute or precedent coordinates behavior only once it is common knowledge (Theorem 3.5 of Part IV). In Section 5, Hart's triad appears as the arcs $\mathsf{I} \to \mathsf{P}$, $\mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{J}$, $\mathsf{J} \to \mathsf{P}$ and $\mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{I}$, which make the three secondary functions mutually reachable whenever rules change through both legislation and precedent.

4.8 Functional explanation

Theorem 4.3 is a condition of persistence. It does not explain why any particular institution exists, and it asserts no feedback from the effects of an institution to its existence, which Elster required of functional explanation (Elster, 1979, 1983). It says nothing about why the Nuer had a leopard-skin chief or why Bourbon France sold judicial offices. Older lists of functional prerequisites drifted toward tautology because they defined prerequisites by what persisting societies happened to have (Section 10); the present derivation avoids the drift because each premise can be false and Proposition 4.4 exhibits persistent collectives in which it is.

5 The dependency structure

5.1 Dependency as a directed hypergraph

Proposition A speaks of the six functions "together with the dependency relations among them". The pillar Parts found two dependencies that a directed graph cannot express. An effective judicial determination needs either legitimacy or an expected sanction, and neither by itself (Proposition 3.6 of Part III). Large-scale sanctioning needs either material provisioning or legitimation, but only when sanctions are costly public goods (Proposition 3.6 and Corollary 3.7 of Part V). A dependency on one of several functions is a hyperarc. Directed hypergraphs of this kind, with reachability through hyperarcs whose whole tail has been reached, are standard in the study of AND/OR structures (Gallo et al., 1993).

Definition 5.1 (Dependency hypergraph)**.** A *hyperarc* is a pair (T, m) with $m \in \mathcal{M}$ and $\emptyset \neq T \subseteq \mathcal{M} \setminus \{m\}$. The hyperarc (T, m) belongs to the dependency structure $\mathcal{D}(G)$ of a collective if, almost surely on Π, infinitely many of the instances that the practices of m solve are solved only with an output of at least one function in T: if every function in T withheld its output, each of those instances would be left unsolved. The instances of each function are those of its implementation predicate: conflicts over goods for F, collective decisions for P, residual disputes for J, entrants in a window for I, agent-periods under the rule for C, and periods of production for W. When $T = \{n\}$ the hyperarc is an *arc*, written

$n \to m$, with the provider on the left. A hyperarc with $|T| \geq 2$ is a disjunction: m needs some member of T, not all of them.

Definition 5.2 (Connectivity and cascade)**.** The *underlying digraph* of $\mathcal{D}$ has an arc $t \to m$ for every $(T, m) \in \mathcal{D}$ and every $t \in T$. For $S \subseteq \mathcal{M}$ the *cascade* $\mathrm{cl}_{\mathcal{D}}(S)$ is the smallest set that contains S and contains m whenever $(T, m) \in \mathcal{D}$ and $T \subseteq \mathrm{cl}_{\mathcal{D}}(S)$. $\mathcal{D}$ is *strongly connected* if its underlying digraph is, and *cascade-complete* if $\mathrm{cl}_{\mathcal{D}}(\{n\}) = \mathcal{M}$ for every n. The *interdependence predicate* $\mathsf{Inter}(G)$ holds if $\mathcal{D}(G)$ is strongly connected and cascade-complete.

The cascade $\mathrm{cl}_{\mathcal{D}}(S)$ is the set of functions that fail when the functions in S withhold their outputs, propagated through the instances of Definition 5.1. Strong connectivity says that every function is linked to every other by a chain of dependencies. Cascade completeness says more: the failure of any single function brings down all the others. The two notions coincide for digraphs and come apart for hypergraphs, because a disjunctive hyperarc transmits failure only when its whole tail has failed.

Remark 5.3 (Dependency through persistence). If $n \to m$ were defined to mean that the collective stops persisting when n is withheld, Theorem 4.3 would make every function depend on every other at no cost: withholding any function ends persistence, and every implementation predicate is defined on the persistence event. Definition 5.1 excludes this by requiring that the instances of m use an output of T directly. Interdependence in the present sense is a claim about how the functions operate, and it does not follow from Proposition A.

5.2 Dependencies derived from the axioms

Lemma 5.4 (Derived dependencies)**.** *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 4.3,* $\mathcal{D}(G)$ *contains*

$$\mathcal{D}_0 = \{\mathsf{W} \to \mathsf{F},\ \mathsf{W} \to \mathsf{P},\ \mathsf{W} \to \mathsf{J},\ \mathsf{W} \to \mathsf{I},\ \mathsf{W} \to \mathsf{C},\ (\{\mathsf{I}, \mathsf{C}\}, \mathsf{J}),\ \mathsf{I} \to \mathsf{F}\}.$$

It need not contain the arc $\mathsf{I} \to \mathsf{J}$ *or the arc* $\mathsf{C} \to \mathsf{J}$.

Proof. Production. By the last clause of Ax6*, every practice is performed only when its performers' consumption is met. The initial stock is finite and consumption is at least $k > 0$ per period, so without produced inflows the stock is exhausted after at most X_0/k periods (Lemma 3.3 of Part VI). Every instance of every other function that falls after that date is solved only if productive activity, by members or by outsiders (Lemma 3.4 of Part VI), supplies the practitioners' consumption. On Π each function solves infinitely many instances, so $\mathsf{W} \to m$ for every $m \neq \mathsf{W}$.

Interpretation. By the compliance clause of Ax3*, which is the model of Proposition 3.6 of Part III, a losing party that gains $g > 0$ by defiance complies if and only if $\ell + \sigma \geq g$, where ℓ is the value it places on the procedure's legitimacy and σ the expected sanction. A party to a residual dispute strictly prefers its own verdict (Definition 2.2 of Part III), so $g > 0$. If legitimation and sanction both withhold their outputs, then $\ell = \sigma = 0$ by Ax3* and no determination is effective, so $\mathsf{Impl}_{\mathsf{J}}$ requires an output of legitimation or of sanction for each effective determination, and $(\{\mathsf{I}, \mathsf{C}\}, \mathsf{J}) \in \mathcal{D}(G)$. In the collective of Proposition 4.4(a) with the fine $d \geq g$ also attached to defiance of a determination, each determination is effective with either output alone, so neither $\mathsf{I} \to \mathsf{J}$ nor $\mathsf{C} \to \mathsf{J}$ belongs to $\mathcal{D}(G)$.

Allocation and recognition. A conflict is settled only if members can anticipate the assignment from a description of the procedure (Definition 2.2(b) of Part I), which requires that they know the procedure. Settlement procedures belong to the rule system whose common knowledge Ax4* requires, and under Ax4* every window of length L contains a

member of the cooperating core who entered without knowing the rule system (Lemma 3.4 of Part IV) and came to know it only through practices of the legitimation function (Theorem 3.5 of Part IV). The conflicts that such members are party to after entry, which recur on Π by the last clause of Ax4*, are settled only with that output, so $\mathsf{I} \to \mathsf{F}$. □

Corollary 5.5 (Structural necessity with dependencies)**.** *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 4.3,* $\mathsf{Struct}(G)$ *holds. If every functioning human collective satisfies the refined axioms,* $\mathsf{Struct}(G)$ *holds for every* $G \in \mathcal{G}$*.*

Proof. Theorem 4.3 gives $\mathsf{Impl}_m(G)$ for every m almost surely on Π, and Lemma 5.4, whose hypotheses are those of the theorem, gives $\mathcal{D}_0 \subseteq \mathcal{D}(G)$. The second sentence is the first under the bridge hypothesis. □

The structure $\mathcal{D}_0$ is not strongly connected. No arc enters W, and P and J have no outgoing arc, and C has one only through the disjunctive hyperarc. Apart from the compliance clause of Ax3* and the settlement-procedure and entrant clauses of Ax4*, the six axioms constrain each function separately. The next subsection adds the incidences on production, rule making, interpretation and coercion.

5.3 Incidence axioms

The six problems converge on one object in every collective that the pillar Parts examined: the rules that assign goods. A settlement procedure is a rule that must be changed when circumstances change, interpreted when its application is disputed, known to those it binds, enforced against those tempted to breach it, and applied to the inputs of production. Each of these is an incidence of one axiom on the financial pillar. They are stated as axioms because they are claims about collective life that the six axioms do not imply (Proposition 5.11(a)), and each comes with a falsifier.

Assumption 5.6 (X1, contested inputs)**.** In infinitely many periods on Π, productive activity uses inputs, such as land, water, tools or equipment, that are goods under conflicting claims in the sense of Definition 2.1 of Part I, and an input is used productively only under an assignment that its user can anticipate.

Assumption 5.7 (X2, changing environment)**.** On Π the environment changes infinitely often in the sense of Assumption 3.2 of Part II, and each change creates conflicts over goods that no settlement procedure in force before the change can settle.

Assumption 5.8 (X3, open-textured allocation)**.** Some settlement procedure in force has open texture in the sense of Definition 2.1 of Part III, and on Π infinitely many residual disputes about its application arise that a move does not escape, subject to the hazard of Ax3*.

Assumption 5.9 (X5, tempting allocation)**.** Ax5* holds for some settlement procedure in force: the share of members who would gain from breaching its assignment in the absence of any response by others, net of every internal cost, exceeds the violation rate the collective can tolerate.

The incidence clauses of Ax4* fail for a collective whose entrants are never parties to conflicts over goods, or whose settlement procedures are run by specialists whose rules the parties need not know, although where such specialists belong to the cooperating core and

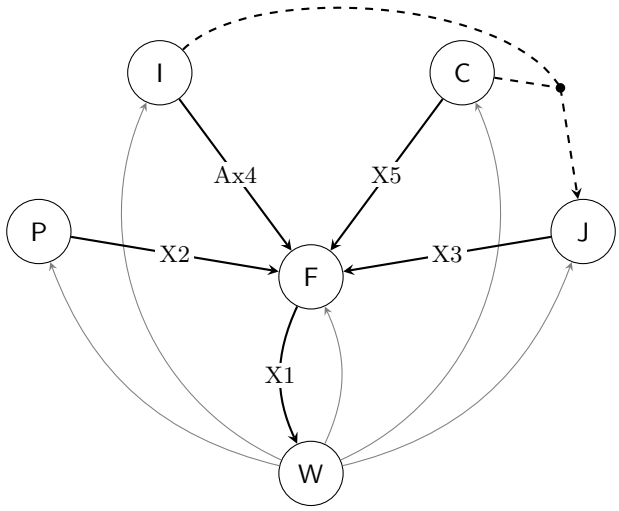


Figure 1: The dependency structure $\mathcal{D}^*$ of Theorem 5.10. Gray arcs run from production to every other function. Solid labeled arcs enter allocation and production and carry the premise that yields them. The dashed hyperarc joins legitimation and coercion at a point before reaching interpretation, because interpretation needs one of the two and not both.

parties anticipate assignments through them, as in complex polities with tax codes or credit rules, the clause holds; the compliance clause of Ax3* fails for a losing party that complies with no legitimating belief and no expected sanction. The falsifiers of the four incidence axioms are direct. X1 fails for a collective that sustains production on inputs nobody else claims, or on inputs whose use is decided each period by unregulated contest. X2 fails for a long-lived collective that meets new kinds of conflicting claims without ever changing its allocation rules. X3 fails for a collective whose allocation rules never produce a dispute that the parties cannot settle by bargaining. X5 fails for a collective in which the temptation to breach every allocation rule, measured independently of sanction practices, stays below a tolerance preregistered for that rule. The pillar Parts report evidence against each such collective. Foragers who own no land in the agrarian sense still hold kin-based rights to territory and water (Part I, Section 3). Ellickson's ranchers changed their norms when trespass and fencing conditions changed (Ellickson, 1991). The Nuer settled homicide by cattle compensation through a mediator because the parties could not settle it alone (Evans-Pritchard, 1940). And Wiessner's records of Ju/'hoansi camp talk show continual criticism of failures to share (Wiessner, 2005), which is what X5 predicts and what a population of untempted members would not need.

5.4 Interdependence

Theorem 5.10 (Interdependence)**.** *Let G satisfy the hypotheses of Lemma 5.4 and Assumptions X1, X2, X3 and X5. Then $\mathcal{D}(G)$ contains*

$$\mathcal{D}^* = \mathcal{D}_0 \cup \{\mathsf{F} \to \mathsf{W},\ \mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{F},\ \mathsf{J} \to \mathsf{F},\ \mathsf{C} \to \mathsf{F}\},$$

$\mathcal{D}^*$ is strongly connected and cascade-complete, and $\mathsf{Inter}(G)$ *holds. If every functioning human collective satisfies the refined axioms and the four incidence axioms, then* $\mathsf{Struct}(G)$

and $\mathsf{Inter}(G)$ *hold for every* $G \in \mathcal{G}$*: every function reaches every other, and the failure of any one propagates to all six.*

Proof. The arcs. $\mathcal{D}_0 \subseteq \mathcal{D}(G)$ by Lemma 5.4. For $\mathsf{F} \to \mathsf{W}$: under X1, the production that uses contested inputs takes place only under an anticipable assignment of those inputs, and on Π such assignments are, in all but finitely many periods, the outputs of settlement (Lemma 4.2); withholding settlement leaves that production undone. For $\mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{F}$: under X2, each change of environment creates conflicts that no procedure in force can settle, so they are settled only after the rule system has been replaced; by Lemma 4.2 all but finitely many of these conflicts are settled, so the rule system is replaced after all but finitely many changes, and the self-government clause of Ax2* makes each replacement a practice of the members, so the procedures that settle the new conflicts are outputs of rule making. For $\mathsf{J} \to \mathsf{F}$: under X3, Lemma 4.1(a), applied to the inescapable disputes about the open-textured procedure, gives, almost surely on Π, all but finitely many of them disposed of by determination; an assignment in the open set of the procedure becomes anticipable only once determined, so the conflicts at issue are settled only with the output of interpretation. For $\mathsf{C} \to \mathsf{F}$: under X5, Lemma 3.3 of Part V with a zero deterrence margin gives a violation probability of at least $p > \theta$ in every agent-period, so withholding sanctions leaves infinitely many assignments breached without anyone being held to them, and those conflicts are unsettled by Definition 2.2(c) of Part I.

Strong connectivity. Each of P, J, I and C has an arc to F, F has an arc to W, and W has an arc to every other function. Every function therefore reaches W within two steps and is reached from W in one.

Cascade completeness. For $n \in \{\mathsf{P}, \mathsf{J}, \mathsf{I}, \mathsf{C}\}$ the arc $n \to \mathsf{F}$ puts F in $\mathrm{cl}(\{n\})$; the arc $\mathsf{F} \to \mathsf{W}$ then puts W in it, and the arcs from W put every function in it. The same chain starts at F, and $\mathrm{cl}(\{\mathsf{W}\}) = \mathcal{M}$ directly.

Monotonicity. Adding hyperarcs adds arcs to the underlying digraph and can only enlarge each cascade, so both properties pass from $\mathcal{D}^*$ to $\mathcal{D}(G)$. The last sentence restates the theorem under the bridge hypothesis. □

Figure 1 draws $\mathcal{D}^*$. Allocation rules are the hub of the dependency structure because the six problems converge on them, not because resource controllers dominate. The hub of dependency and the hub of integration are different objects. A polity in which the allocation rules are made by a dispersed legislature, interpreted by independent courts, taught by a free press and enforced by accountable police has the same $\mathcal{D}^*$ as one in which a single coalition does all four, and Section 6 shows that the two differ in U_t and $\mathcal{I}_t$.

Proposition 5.11 (Role of each premise)**.**

(a) The refined axioms do not imply interdependence: the collective of Proposition 4.4(a) satisfies Ax1 to Ax6* and* Struct*, and no arc of its dependency structure enters* W*.*

(b) Among the arcs of $\mathcal{D}^*$ *and the further arcs of Remark 5.12, the only arc into* W *is* $\mathsf{F} \to \mathsf{W}$*; without X1 no structure built from them is strongly connected.*

(c) Without X5, the structure $\mathcal{D}^* \setminus \{\mathsf{C} \to \mathsf{F}\}$ *is strongly connected but not cascade-complete:* $\mathrm{cl}(\{\mathsf{C}\}) = \{\mathsf{C}\}$*.*

(d) Without X3, replacing $\mathsf{J} \to \mathsf{F}$ *by the precedent arc* $\mathsf{J} \to \mathsf{P}$ *of Remark 5.12 keeps the structure strongly connected and cascade-complete.*

(e) If the hyperarc $(\{\mathsf{I},\mathsf{C}\},\mathsf{J})$ *is replaced by the two arcs* $\mathsf{I}\to\mathsf{J}$ *and* $\mathsf{C}\to\mathsf{J}$*, then the cascade of* $\{\mathsf{C}\}$ *in* $\mathcal{D}^*\setminus\{\mathsf{C}\to\mathsf{F}\}$ *becomes* $\mathcal{M}$*.*

Proof. (a) Foraging is individual, does not depend on the campsite chosen, uses no contested input and is not governed by the rule of camp chores, so no instance of W uses an output of another function. (b) No other listed arc has head W, and a digraph with no arc into a vertex is not strongly connected. (c) The arcs of $\mathcal{D}^*$ other than $\mathsf{C}\to\mathsf{F}$ still give every function a path to W, since C reaches J in the underlying digraph and $\mathsf{J}\to\mathsf{F}$. In the cascade, C appears in the tail of only one hyperarc, $(\{\mathsf{I},\mathsf{C}\},\mathsf{J})$, which fires only if I has also failed. (d) $\mathsf{J}\to\mathsf{P}\to\mathsf{F}$ replaces $\mathsf{J}\to\mathsf{F}$ in both arguments of Theorem 5.10. (e) With the arc $\mathsf{C}\to\mathsf{J}$, the chain $\mathsf{C}\to\mathsf{J}\to\mathsf{F}\to\mathsf{W}$ fires and W reaches every function. □

Part (e) is the reason to use hyperarcs. The arc representation would assert that a collapse of coercion disables interpretation. Part III showed the opposite: a determination that the parties regard as legitimate settles the dispute with no sanction behind it. Part (c) shows what X5 contributes. Without it, coercion is linked to the other functions but its failure stays local, because interpretation can rest on legitimacy alone and nothing else uses coercion directly.

Part V's exception for bilateral exclusion does not touch the theorem. Corollary 3.7 of Part V concerns the motivation of sanctioners: when a cheated trader simply refuses to deal again with the cheat, the refusal costs nothing and needs neither provisioning nor legitimation, so the hyperarc $(\{\mathsf{F},\mathsf{I}\},\mathsf{C})$ is absent. Theorem 5.10 uses no arc into coercion except $\mathsf{W}\to\mathsf{C}$, and that arc holds for bilateral exclusion too. The trader who withholds cooperation is an agent whose consumption is counted in Ax6*, and the cooperation withheld is itself an exchange of produced goods; without production there is nothing to withhold and nobody to withhold it. The arc out of coercion that the theorem uses, $\mathsf{C}\to\mathsf{F}$, rests on X5 and on Lemma 3.3 of Part V, which say only that without any response to breach the breach rate exceeds tolerance. Bilateral exclusion is one such response. When it is the only one, coercion is exercised in its most dispersed form, and the arc is unaffected.

A second route from legitimation to coercion exists, and it does not rest on reading equilibrium beliefs as legitimacy. Under Ax4*, every window contains an entrant who did not know the rule system at entry (Lemma 3.4 of Part IV). A sanction rule deters such an entrant only once the entrant can tell which conduct the others will answer with exclusion, fines or force, and the practices that supply that information to entrants are the ones Theorem 3.5 of Part IV assigns to legitimation. The argument concerns the information of particular members who arrive uninformed, not the beliefs that sanctioners hold in equilibrium. It yields the arc $\mathsf{I}\to\mathsf{C}$ whenever sanction rules belong to the rule system whose common knowledge Ax4* requires. The theorem does not need this arc, and Remark 5.12 lists it with the others.

Every arc of $\mathcal{D}^*$ appears in the minimal forms of Table 2, without offices. Among the Ju/'hoansi, foraging feeds the people who talk disputes out and criticize stinginess ($\mathsf{W}\to m$); arrow-owner rules are learned in talk that everyone hears ($\mathsf{I}\to\mathsf{F}$); access to territory and water runs through rights held by kin ($\mathsf{F}\to\mathsf{W}$); disputes over sharing are talked out ($\mathsf{J}\to\mathsf{F}$); and criticism of failures to share, recorded by Wiessner, holds people to the sharing rules ($\mathsf{C}\to\mathsf{F}$) (Lee, 2013; Wiessner, 2005). Among the Nuer, cattle rights govern herding ($\mathsf{F}\to\mathsf{W}$), compensation in cattle after a homicide is fixed through the leopard-skin chief ($\mathsf{J}\to\mathsf{F}$), and the settlement holds because the parties value it and fear renewed feud, which is the disjunction of $(\{\mathsf{I},\mathsf{C}\},\mathsf{J})$ (Evans-Pritchard, 1940). In Ostrom's commons, users modify their appropriation rules through collective-choice arrangements ($\mathsf{P}\to\mathsf{F}$), resolve conflicts over

them in local arenas ($\mathsf{J} \to \mathsf{F}$), monitor and sanction appropriators ($\mathsf{C} \to \mathsf{F}$), and draw provision labor from the users themselves under the same rules ($\mathsf{F} \to \mathsf{W}$) (Ostrom, 1990). The dependency structure is the same in a band as in an empire. What differs is who sits at each node.

Remark 5.12 (Further arcs). Other incidences yield arcs that the theorem does not need. A replaced rule coordinates behavior only once it is common knowledge, so $\mathsf{I} \to \mathsf{P}$ whenever rules change (Part IV, Section 3). Under changes that alter the rules of adjudication and recognition, $\mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{J}$ and $\mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{I}$. Where determinations bind later cases, interpretation changes rules, so $\mathsf{J} \to \mathsf{P}$; with the arcs $\mathsf{I} \to \mathsf{P}$, $\mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{J}$ and $\mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{I}$ this makes Hart's three secondary functions mutually reachable. Where sanctions are costly public goods delivered at large scale without higher-order sanctions, $(\{\mathsf{F}, \mathsf{I}\}, \mathsf{C})$ by Corollary 3.7 of Part V, which gives a micro-foundation for the coupling of war making and extraction that Tilly (1990) described. When sanctions take the form of bilateral exclusion, Part V shows that sanctioners need no provisioning or legitimation, and the hyperarc is absent. Where sanction rules belong to the rule system whose common knowledge Ax4* requires, informing entrants of them yields $\mathsf{I} \to \mathsf{C}$, as argued above.

6 Capture

6.1 Integration

The source defines cross-pillar integration descriptively, and Part II proposed a formal candidate for pairs that include rule making (Section 6 of Part II, Equation 2). The series adopts it for all fifteen pairs.

Definition 6.1 (Coalition-overlap integration)**.** Let $\mathcal{S}$ be a preregistered list of coherent coalitions, groups such as parties, firms, dynasties or factions that can issue joint directives. For $S \in \mathcal{S}$ and a pillar m, let $\kappa_m(S) \in [0,1]$ be the share of decision-relevant control in m that is exercised in accordance with the directives of S; for $m = \mathsf{P}$ it is the bloc share of Part II. Then

$$C^{\mathrm{ov}}_{mn} = \max_{S \in \mathcal{S}} \min\{\kappa_m(S), \kappa_n(S)\}.$$

The measure lies in $[0,1]$, equals one exactly when some listed coalition commands all of both pillars, and equals zero exactly when no listed coalition has a positive share in both. Its value depends on the coalition list, which is why the list must be fixed before coding. Write $\deg_m = \sum_{n \neq m} C_{mn}$ for the integration degree of pillar m.

Lemma 6.2 (Degree, star and clique bounds)**.** *For any symmetric C with entries in $[0,1]$ and $M = 6$:*

(a) $\mathcal{I} = \frac{1}{M(M-1)} \sum_m \deg_m = \frac{1}{30} \sum_m \deg_m$*;*

(b) if $C_{mn} = 0$ whenever neither m nor n lies in a set A of k pillars, then $\mathcal{I} \le \bar{c}\,(k(M-k) + k(k-1)/2)/15$ with $\bar{c} = \max_{m<n} C_{mn}$; for a single hub, $k = 1$, the bound is $\bar{c}/3$;

(c) under Definition 6.1, if a coalition $S \in \mathcal{S}$ has $\kappa_m(S) \ge c$ for every m in a set A of k pillars, then $C_{mn} \ge c$ for all distinct $m, n \in A$ and $\mathcal{I} \ge c\,k(k-1)/30$.

Proof. (a) Each pair $\{m, n\}$ appears in $\deg_m$ and in $\deg_n$, so $\sum_m \deg_m = 2 \sum_{m<n} C_{mn}$, and $\mathcal{I} = \frac{2}{M(M-1)} \sum_{m<n} C_{mn}$. (b) The pairs with at least one member in A number

$k(M-k)+k(k-1)/2$; each contributes at most $\bar{c}$ and the others contribute zero; divide by fifteen. (c) For $m,n \in A$, $C^{\text{ov}}_{mn} \geq \min\{\kappa_m(S), \kappa_n(S)\} \geq c$. The $k(k-1)/2$ such pairs contribute at least $c\,k(k-1)/2$ to the sum, and $\mathcal{I}$ is that sum divided by fifteen. □

The lemma separates two patterns that comparative accounts often run together. In a star, one pillar is coupled to the others by different coalitions, and the remaining pillars are not coupled to one another: with $k = 1$, integration cannot exceed one third of the largest coupling. In a clique, one coalition commands several pillars, and the overlap measure forces every pair among them to be coupled: a coalition that commands a share c of five pillars produces $\mathcal{I} \geq 2c/3$. A threshold i^* above one third therefore cannot be met by a pure star, whatever its couplings. The distinction is the formal content of the source's warning that strong organizations do not by themselves imply a strong coalition (Largo, 2026).

6.2 The capture predicate

Definition 6.3 (Capture predicate)**.** Fix preregistered thresholds $(u^*, i^*) \in (0,1]^2$ and weights ω. Let L_t be the set of capture links documented at t, each meeting the source's three conditions. Then $\mathsf{Cap}_{u^*,i^*}(G,t)$ holds if $U_t \geq u^*$, $\mathcal{I}_t \geq i^*$ and $L_t \neq \emptyset$. Proposition B for a polity in a period is the statement that Cap holds.

The source's stricter classification adds documented unaccountable concentration in at least two pillars, persistent restriction of effective contestation, and a materially consequential pattern linked to the concentrated coalition (Largo, 2026). These refine the predicate and do not change its logic. The predicate is defined only when each pillar has a control-share vector, so capture presupposes that the six functions are realized. The converse is the subject of this section.

Lemma 6.4 (Range of unaccountable concentration)**.** *(a)* $0 \leq U_t \leq 1$. *(b)* $U_t = 0$ *if and only if* $Q_m = 1$ *for every* m *with* $\omega_m > 0$. *(c)* $\min_m H_m(1-Q_m) \leq U_t \leq \max_m H_m(1-Q_m)$, *and both bounds are attained at vertices of the weight simplex.*

Proof. Each term $H_m(1-Q_m)$ lies in $[0,1]$, and U_t is their convex combination, which gives (a) and (c); the bounds of (c) are attained by putting all weight on a minimizing or a maximizing pillar. For (b), a pillar with holders has $H_m \geq 1/n_m > 0$, so a term with positive weight vanishes only if $Q_m = 1$. □

Part (c) bounds the effect of the weights: however they are chosen, U_t stays in the interval spanned by the pillar terms, which is why the source requires them to be preregistered.

6.3 Non-implication

Lemma 6.5 (Separation)**.** *Describe a model of a collective as a pair* (Γ, Λ). Γ *consists of the processes of arrivals, dispositions, hazards, temptations and margins, information partitions, and stocks and flows.* Λ *consists of the role map, the control shares, the coalition list with its control shares* κ*, the contestability components, and the record of evidence on capture links. Call* Λ *admissible if every agent it assigns to a practice is a member, or an organization of members, whose consumption is counted in Ax6*; no party to a residual dispute alone controls its determination; and the practices of rule making are the members' own. The refined axioms, the incidence axioms, the implementation predicates and the dependency structure are, for admissible* Λ*, functions of* Γ *alone.* U_t*,* $\mathcal{I}_t$ *and* L_t *are functions of* Λ *alone.*

Proof. Table 1, Definitions 2.2 and 5.1 and Assumptions X1, X2, X3 and X5 (assumptions 5.6 to 5.9) refer to whether conflicts are settled, decisions made, disputes determined, information refined, violations met and inflows produced, and to the hazards and temptations attached to these events. None refers to a share, to a coalition, to a contestability component or to evidence of privileged access. Admissibility fixes the only clauses that mention performers: the party-control clause of Impl_J, the self-government clause of Ax2* and the practice clause of Ax6*. U_t is computed from shares and contestability, $\mathcal{I}_t$ from the coalition list and κ, and L_t from the evidentiary record. □

Theorem 6.6 (Proposition A does not imply Proposition B)**.** *There are four collectives, each satisfying Ax1* to Ax6* and X1, X2, X3 and X5, and hence* Struct *and* Inter*, whose pairs $(U_t, \mathcal{I}_t)$ are $(0,0)$, $(0,1)$, $(1,0)$ and $(1,1)$, and of which only the last has a documented capture link. Consequently, for every pair of thresholds $(u^*, i^*) \in (0,1]^2$, structural necessity and interdependence hold both in a collective where* Cap *holds and in collectives where it fails, and neither $U_t \geq u^*$ nor $\mathcal{I}_t \geq i^*$ implies* Cap*.*

Proof. Extend the collective of Proposition 4.4(a) to at least twelve members and adjust four components so that the incidence axioms hold. The contested plot is the field the members cultivate, so production uses an input under an anticipable assignment (X1). The environment alternates between two states, and each change brings a new kind of claim that the old rotation rule does not cover, which the members settle by voting a new rule (X2). The residual disputes concern the application of the rotation rule to boundary cases (X3). Members are tempted to take the field out of turn with $p > \theta$, and a member who does so pays a fine and is made to return the field, so the conflict counts as settled (X5). Call the resulting processes Γ. By Corollary 5.5 and Theorem 5.10, Γ yields Struct and Inter, and by Lemma 6.5 it does so under any admissible assignment Λ of the practices to agents. Four assignments give the corners. In each corner the organizations consist of members, every determination is made by an organization that contains neither party (in $(0,1)$ by all members, so neither party controls it alone), and the procedures are those of Γ with performers relabeled, so each assignment is admissible.

$(0,0)$: each pillar's practices are performed by two organizations with equal shares, the twelve organizations are distinct, $\mathcal{S}$ lists only single organizations, and $Q_m = 1$ for every m. Then $H_m = 1/2$, $U_t = 0$ by Lemma 6.4(b), every $C_{mn} = 0$, $\mathcal{I}_t = 0$, and the record contains no capture link.

$(0,1)$: every member takes an equal part in every practice by consensus, the coalition of all members is listed, and $Q_m = 1$. Then $U_t = 0$ and, by Lemma 4.5, $\mathcal{I}_t = 1$; the record contains no capture link.

$(1,0)$: each pillar's practices are performed by a single organization, the six organizations are distinct, $\mathcal{S}$ lists only single organizations, and $Q_m = 0$. Then $H_m = 1$, $U_t = 1$, every $C_{mn} = 0$, $\mathcal{I}_t = 0$, and the record contains no capture link.

$(1,1)$: one organization performs every practice and $Q_m = 0$. Then $H_m = 1$, $U_t = 1$, $\kappa_m = 1$ for that organization in every pillar, $\mathcal{I}_t = 1$, and the record documents one capture link: the organization's discretion over determinations removes review, and a record ties that discretion to an assignment of the field.

For thresholds in $(0,1]^2$, the collective at $(1,1)$ satisfies Cap, the one at $(0,0)$ does not, the one at $(1,0)$ fails $\mathcal{I}_t \geq i^*$ although $U_t \geq u^*$, and the one at $(0,1)$ fails $U_t \geq u^*$ although $\mathcal{I}_t \geq i^*$. □

The theorem formalizes three of the source's commitments. Differentiated functions do

not establish a common hierarchy (source Proposition 1): the corner $(1, 0)$ has six monopolies and no coalition among them. Integration of functions is not capture: the corner $(0, 1)$ is the minimal form of the stateless societies. And the strong claim requires both indices and a documented link, because each index alone is compatible with its absence. Structural necessity fixes the support of the role map. Capture is a claim about its values.

7 Representation and minimality

7.1 The Formalized State as an abstraction

The results so far concern properties that every functioning collective has. This section states them as a single claim about an abstraction. The Formalized State is not a form of government. It is a class of mathematical structures, and the claim is that every governance system, whatever its period, ideology, institutions or degree of centralization, is represented by a member of the class. Historical regimes are instances. The name "Beast System" is the series' typological reading of the abstraction (Section 11); it is not a conclusion of any theorem.

Definition 7.1 (Formalized State structure)**.** A *Formalized State structure* is a tuple $F = (V, \rho, A, s, Q, \omega, \mathcal{S}, \kappa, L, \mathcal{D})$ in which V is a finite nonempty set of actors, $\rho : V \to 2^{\mathcal{M}}$ is a role map, $A = (A^m)_{m\in\mathcal{M}}$ are layers with entries in $[0, 1]$, $s = (s^m)_{m\in\mathcal{M}}$ are vectors on V, $Q \in [0, 1]^{\mathcal{M}}$, ω is a weight vector on $\mathcal{M}$, $\mathcal{S}$ is a list of subsets of V with control shares $\kappa_m(S) \in [0, 1]$, L is a finite set of capture links $(i \to j, m)$ with $i, j \in V$, and $\mathcal{D}$ is a set of hyperarcs on $\mathcal{M}$, subject to four conditions. Write $V_m = \{v \in V : m \in \rho(v)\}$.

(F1) Every function has a holder: $V_m \neq \emptyset$ for every $m \in \mathcal{M}$.

(F2) Control lies with holders: each s^m is a probability vector with $s^m_v > 0$ only if $v \in V_m$, and $a^m_{ij} > 0$ only if $i \in V_m$.

(F3) The measurement components are in range: $\omega \geq 0$ with $\sum_m \omega_m = 1$.

(F4) The dependency structure contains $\mathcal{D}_0$ and is strongly connected and cascade-complete.

The class of all such structures is $\mathcal{F}$. Each $F \in \mathcal{F}$ determines H_m, U, C^{ov}_{mn}, $\mathcal{I}$ and the capture predicate by the formulas of Sections 2 and 6.

The definition is purely mathematical. It does not mention any society, and checking whether a tuple belongs to $\mathcal{F}$ requires no knowledge of governance. Membership in $\mathcal{G}$, conversely, is checked without the pillars (Definition 2.1). The bridge between the two classes is a map that reads a structure off the coded record of a collective.

Definition 7.2 (Profile map)**.** Let $G \in \mathcal{G}$ come with a coded record that lists, for each practice that recurs on Π, the actors who perform it and the actors it constrains, together with the contestability components, a preregistered coalition list with the share of each pillar's control that each coalition directs, the documented capture links, and preregistered weights. The *profile* $\pi(G) = (V_G, \rho_G, A_G, s_G, Q_G, \omega, \mathcal{S}_G, \kappa_G, L_G, \mathcal{D}(G))$ is built in five steps.

(i) V_G is the set of actors who perform some practice.

(ii) $m \in \rho_G(v)$ if and only if $\mathsf{Impl}_m(G)$ holds and v performs a practice of the class that Definition 2.2 assigns to m. A function that is not implemented receives no holders.

(iii) s^m_G is computed by the share rule of the Part that owns m: the stake-weighted share of last words for J (Part III, Section 2), the power index of the decision procedure for P (Part II, Section 2), deployment command for C (Definition 2.2 of Part V), and the corresponding rules of Parts I, IV and VI. A^m_G records the documented constraints.

(iv) Q_G, ω, $\mathcal{S}_G$, κ_G and L_G are copied from the record.

(v) $\mathcal{D}(G)$ is the dependency structure of Definition 5.1.

The record is well formed: each share rule returns a probability vector supported on the actors who perform practices of m, a constraint (i, j, m) is recorded only if i performs a practice of m, and the weights are nonnegative and sum to one. For $G \in \mathcal{G}$ and $F \in \mathcal{F}$, write $G \cong_A F$ if there is a bijection $\beta : V_G \to V_F$ that carries every component of $\pi(G)$ to the corresponding component of F. For $G, G' \in \mathcal{G}$ write $G \cong_A G'$ if a bijection $V_G \to V_{G'}$ carries $\pi(G)$ to $\pi(G')$.

The profile is well defined on coded records. Steps (i), (ii), (iv) and (v) are determined by the record and the definitions, and step (iii) applies share rules that the pillar Parts fixed in advance; two codings of the same record differ at most by a relabeling of actors, which $\cong_A$ ignores. The relation $\cong_A$ is equivalence in the governance properties the abstraction keeps. It is not isomorphism of social detail, and the next lemma says exactly what is kept and what is not.

Lemma 7.3 (Preserved and forgotten properties)**.** *If $G \cong_A F$, then G and F have the same role map, control shares, concentrations H_m, contestability Q_m, unaccountable concentration U, couplings C^{ov}_{mn}, integration $\mathcal{I}$, capture predicate for every threshold pair, dependency structure, and interdependence predicate, all up to the relabeling β. The relation $\cong_A$ does not preserve, and the abstraction does not represent, the content of the rules, the beliefs that legitimate them, the particular procedures that implement each function, the identities and histories of actors beyond their labels, the levels of capacity x_t, the quality or welfare consequences of decisions, or any moral evaluation of the system.*

Proof. Each preserved quantity is a function of the components that β carries over: H_m of s^m; U of s, Q and ω; C^{ov}_{mn} and $\mathcal{I}$ of $\mathcal{S}$ and κ; the capture predicate of U, $\mathcal{I}$ and L; interdependence of $\mathcal{D}$. The forgotten items are not components of $\pi(G)$, so collectives that differ only in them have the same profile. Two examples show that the loss is real: a consensus band and a council of equals in a commons with the same number of members, the same contestability and the same dependency structure have the same image, and so do two monarchies that differ only in their official religion. □

7.2 The representation theorem

Theorem 7.4 (Representation)**.** *Let $G \in \mathcal{G}$ come with a well-formed coded record.*

(a) $G \cong_A F$ for some $F \in \mathcal{F}$ if and only if Struct(G) *and* Inter(G) *hold.*

(b) If G satisfies Ax1 to Ax6* and X1, X2, X3 and X5, then $F_G = \pi(G)$ belongs to $\mathcal{F}$ and $G \cong_A F_G$.*

(c) If every functioning human collective satisfies the refined and incidence axioms, then for every $G \in \mathcal{G}$ there is $F_G \in \mathcal{F}$ with $G \cong_A F_G$.

Proof. (a) Suppose $\mathsf{Struct}(G)$ and $\mathsf{Inter}(G)$. Each $\mathsf{Impl}_m(G)$ requires practices of m's class that recur on Π, so step (ii) gives every function at least one holder, which is (F1). Since control in each pillar is exercised, the share rule of step (iii) yields a probability vector supported on the actors who exercise it, and documented constraints run only from holders, which is (F2). (F3) holds for preregistered weights. $\mathsf{Struct}(G)$ gives $\mathcal{D}_0 \subseteq \mathcal{D}(G)$ and $\mathsf{Inter}(G)$ gives strong connectivity and cascade completeness, which is (F4). So $\pi(G) \in \mathcal{F}$, and the identity map gives $G \cong_A \pi(G)$. Conversely, if $G \cong_A F$ with $F \in \mathcal{F}$, then by (F1) every function of G has a holder, which by step (ii) happens only if $\mathsf{Impl}_m(G)$ holds for every m; by (F4) $\mathcal{D}(G) = \mathcal{D}_F$ contains $\mathcal{D}_0$ and is strongly connected and cascade-complete, so $\mathsf{Struct}(G)$ and $\mathsf{Inter}(G)$ hold. (b) Corollary 5.5 and Theorem 5.10 give $\mathsf{Struct}(G)$ and $\mathsf{Inter}(G)$, and (a) applies with $F_G = \pi(G)$. (c) is (b) under the bridge hypothesis. □

Universality over real governance systems is part (b) together with the empirical bridge that every functioning collective satisfies the refined and incidence axioms, which historical observation supports.

Part (a) locates the content of the theorem. The profile map is defined for every collective, so the existence of a map is not the claim. The claim is that the image lands in $\mathcal{F}$: that every functioning collective has six nonempty layers with well-defined control shares and an interdependent dependency structure. That is exactly Proposition A, so the representation theorem is Proposition A stated as a property of an abstraction, and its proof runs through Theorems 4.3 and 5.10. The representation can fail. The six collectives of Proposition 4.4(b) each have a function with no holders, so by (a) no structure in $\mathcal{F}$ represents them; the collective of Proposition 4.4(a) has all six functions but no arc into production (Proposition 5.11(a)), so it fails (F4) and is not represented either. Whether a real collective is represented is therefore an empirical question, and the bridge hypothesis is the claim that the answer is always yes.

Four results of the paper should be kept apart. Representation (Theorem 7.4) says that every governance system is an instance of the abstraction. Necessity (Theorems 4.3 and 5.10) says why: the properties that membership requires follow from primitive axioms about collective life. Minimality (Proposition 7.5) says that no coarsening of the abstraction preserves the same properties. Uniqueness (Theorems 7.7 and 7.8) says that the abstraction is the coarsest one that does, up to a unique isomorphism, and that it has exactly six dimensions.

7.3 Minimality

Write $\mathcal{G}_*$ for the governance systems that satisfy Ax1* to Ax6*, X1, X2, X3 and X5 and come with a well-formed coded record, and $P(G)$ for the isomorphism class of $\pi(G)$ under relabeling of actors. $P(G)$ is the *preserved property set*: it determines the role map, the control shares, H_m, Q_m, U, C^{ov}_{mn}, $\mathcal{I}$, the capture predicate and the dependency structure, and by Definition 7.2 $G \cong_A G'$ if and only if $P(G) = P(G')$.

An abstraction with fewer or other functional dimensions is obtained by a *coarsening*. A coarsening is a map $c : \mathcal{M} \to K \cup \{\perp\}$ into a finite set K whose image contains K, so that every block $c^{-1}(k)$ is nonempty, together with weights $\lambda_m > 0$ that sum to one on each block $c^{-1}(k)$. It sends a structure to the structure indexed by K in which block k has holders $\bigcup_{m \in c^{-1}(k)} V_m$, shares $\sum_{m \in c^{-1}(k)} \lambda_m s^m$, layers, contestability and coalition shares formed with the same weights, and weight $\sum_{m \in c^{-1}(k)} \omega_m$; pillars with $c(m) = \perp$ are dropped, and the hyperarcs are the images under c of the hyperarcs that contain no dropped pillar, with

self-loops removed. Write $\Phi_c(G)$ for the coarsened image of $\pi(G)$, up to relabeling of actors. The identity coarsening gives $\Phi = \Phi_{\mathrm{id}}$, and $\Phi(G) = P(G)$. The source's five-function model is the coarsening that merges P and J (Largo, 2026).

Proposition 7.5 (Minimality)**.** *Let (c, λ) be a coarsening that is not a bijection from $\mathcal{M}$ onto K. Then there are $G_1, G_2 \in \mathcal{G}_*$ with $\Phi_c(G_1) = \Phi_c(G_2)$ and $P(G_1) \neq P(G_2)$. Explicitly:*

(a) if $c(m) = \perp$ for some m, G_1 and G_2 differ only in that m is held by one organization a in G_1, with $s^m = (1, 0)$ on (a, b), and by a and b equally in G_2, with $s^m = (1/2, 1/2)$; then $H_m = 1$ in G_1 and $H_m = 1/2$ in G_2;

(b) if $c(m) = c(n) \neq \perp$ for some $m \neq n$, let $\mu = \lambda_m/(\lambda_m + \lambda_n)$; G_1 has $s^m = (1, 0)$ and $s^n = (0, 1)$ on (a, b), and G_2 has $s^m = s^n = (\mu, 1 - \mu)$, with the same $Q_m = Q_n$ and with $\mathcal{S}$ listing single organizations; then $C^{\mathrm{ov}}_{mn} = 0$ in G_1 and $\max\{\mu, 1 - \mu\} \geq 1/2$ in G_2, so $\mathcal{I}$ differs by at least $1/30$, and $H_m = H_n = 1$ in G_1 against $\mu^2 + (1 - \mu)^2 < 1$ in G_2.

Proof. A coarsening whose restriction to the pillars not sent to $\perp$ is not a bijection onto K either sends some pillar to $\perp$ or sends two pillars to the same element of K. In both cases start from the collective Γ in the proof of Theorem 6.6, let two organizations a and b perform the practices of the pillars named, code every other pillar identically in G_1 and G_2, and set the layers proportional to the shares, $a^l_{aj} = s^l_a$ and $a^l_{bj} = s^l_b$ for the pillars l named and every other actor j. Since a and b are organizations of members that are parties to no residual dispute, both assignments are admissible, and by Lemma 6.5 G_1 and G_2 satisfy every axiom, since they differ only in the assignment of control, so both lie in $\mathcal{G}_*$.

(a) So that both collectives have the same actor set, let a and b also hold equal shares $(1/2, 1/2)$ in one pillar $l_0 \neq m$, with $c(l_0) \in K$ when $K \neq \emptyset$, identically in G_1 and G_2; in G_1 the organization b, which holds nothing in m, still performs practices of l_0. Dropping m deletes its layer, shares, contestability and coalition shares, removes m from every actor's roles, and deletes every hyperarc that contains m. What remains is identical in G_1 and G_2, so $\Phi_c(G_1) = \Phi_c(G_2)$; if $K = \emptyset$, both images consist of the actor set alone and coincide. The concentration $H_m = 1^2 = 1$ in G_1 and $H_m = 2 \cdot (1/2)^2 = 1/2$ in G_2; a relabeling of actors does not change H_m, so $P(G_1) \neq P(G_2)$.

(b) Here a performs practices of m and b of n in G_1, and both perform both in G_2, so the actor sets coincide; a and b perform no practice of any other pillar. In the block containing m and n, the weighted shares of m and n contribute $\lambda_m(1, 0) + \lambda_n(0, 1) = (\lambda_m, \lambda_n)$ in G_1 and $(\lambda_m + \lambda_n)(\mu, 1 - \mu) = (\lambda_m, \lambda_n)$ in G_2. The coalition shares of the single organizations are $\kappa_l(\{a\}) = s^l_a$ and $\kappa_l(\{b\}) = s^l_b$, so they combine in the same way, as do the layers. Every other component is identical, so $\Phi_c(G_1) = \Phi_c(G_2)$. Before coarsening, $C^{\mathrm{ov}}_{mn} = \max\{\min(1, 0), \min(0, 1)\} = 0$ in G_1 and $\max\{\min(\mu, \mu), \min(1 - \mu, 1 - \mu)\} = \max\{\mu, 1 - \mu\} \geq 1/2$ in G_2; the other fourteen couplings coincide, so $\mathcal{I}$ differs by at least $(1/2)/15 = 1/30$. The concentrations are 1 against $\mu^2 + (1 - \mu)^2$, which is less than one for $\mu \in (0, 1)$. These quantities are invariant under relabeling, so $P(G_1) \neq P(G_2)$. □

The independence of the axioms gives a stronger form of (a) on all of $\mathcal{G}$. The collectives of Proposition 4.4(a) and Proposition 4.4(b), coded with the same actors for the other five functions, have the same image after dropping m_k, although the first implements m_k and the second does not. If one function were implied by the other five, dropping it would lose nothing. Part (b) shows what the source loses by merging rule making with interpretation: a polity whose legislature and courts are held by different organizations and one in which

both share both functions in the same proportions have the same five-function image and different integration.

7.4 Uniqueness

Definition 7.6 (Abstractions)**.** Fix a countable universe of actor labels and dates, and let $\mathcal{G}_*$ consist of the governance systems in it whose coded records use those labels, so that $\mathcal{G}_*$ is a set. An *abstraction* is a surjective map $\alpha : \mathcal{G}_* \to S_\alpha$ onto a set. It is *P-preserving* if P factors through it: $\alpha(G) = \alpha(G')$ implies $P(G) = P(G')$. A *morphism* $\alpha \to \beta$ is a map $h : S_\alpha \to S_\beta$ with $h \circ \alpha = \beta$. Write $\mathbf{Abs}_P$ for the category of P-preserving abstractions and their morphisms. The *Formalized State abstraction* is $\Phi : \mathcal{G}_* \to \mathcal{F}_*$, $\Phi(G) = [\pi(G)]$, where $\mathcal{F}_*$ is the set of isomorphism classes of structures in $\mathcal{F}$ that represent some $G \in \mathcal{G}_*$.

Composition is composition of maps and the identity map is the identity morphism, so $\mathbf{Abs}_P$ is a category. Because abstractions are surjective, there is at most one morphism between two abstractions: h is determined on $S_\alpha = \alpha(\mathcal{G}_*)$ by $h(\alpha(G)) = \beta(G)$.

Theorem 7.7 (Uniqueness)**.** *Relative to the axioms Ax1* to Ax6*, X1, X2, X3 and X5 and the preserved property set P:*

(a) Φ is an object of $\mathbf{Abs}_P$, and two systems have the same image under Φ if and only if $G \cong_A G'$;

(b) Φ is terminal in $\mathbf{Abs}_P$: for every P-preserving abstraction α there is exactly one morphism $\alpha \to \Phi$, so Φ is the coarsest P-preserving abstraction;

(c) every terminal object of $\mathbf{Abs}_P$ is isomorphic to Φ by a unique isomorphism;

(d) for each $G \in \mathcal{G}_*$, the representing structure F_G is unique up to isomorphism: if $G \cong_A F$ and $G \cong_A F'$ with $F, F' \in \mathcal{F}$, then F and F' are isomorphic.

Proof. (a) By Theorem 7.4(b), $\pi(G) \in \mathcal{F}$ for every $G \in \mathcal{G}_*$, so Φ is well defined, and it is surjective onto $\mathcal{F}_*$ by the definition of $\mathcal{F}_*$. $\Phi(G) = \Phi(G')$ means $[\pi(G)] = [\pi(G')]$, which is $P(G) = P(G')$, which is $G \cong_A G'$. In particular $\Phi(G) = \Phi(G')$ implies $P(G) = P(G')$, so Φ is P-preserving.

(b) Let α be P-preserving. Define $h : S_\alpha \to \mathcal{F}_*$ by $h(\alpha(G)) = \Phi(G)$. The definition does not depend on the choice of G: if $\alpha(G) = \alpha(G')$, then $P(G) = P(G')$ because α is P-preserving, and so $\Phi(G) = \Phi(G')$ by (a). Every point of S_α has the form $\alpha(G)$, so h is defined on all of S_α, and $h \circ \alpha = \Phi$ by construction. Any morphism $h' : \alpha \to \Phi$ satisfies $h'(\alpha(G)) = \Phi(G) = h(\alpha(G))$ for every G, so $h' = h$. The partition of $\mathcal{G}_*$ induced by α therefore refines the one induced by Φ, which is the partition into $\cong_A$-classes; no P-preserving abstraction is coarser.

(c) Let Ψ be terminal in $\mathbf{Abs}_P$. Terminality of Φ gives a unique morphism $f : \Psi \to \Phi$, and terminality of Ψ gives a unique morphism $g : \Phi \to \Psi$. Then $f \circ g$ is a morphism $\Phi \to \Phi$, and the identity is another; terminality of Φ allows only one, so $f \circ g = \mathrm{id}$. In the same way $g \circ f = \mathrm{id}$ on Ψ. So f is an isomorphism, and it is the only morphism $\Psi \to \Phi$, hence the only isomorphism.

(d) A relation $G \cong_A F$ is a bijection $\beta : V_G \to V_F$ carrying $\pi(G)$ to F, and $G \cong_A F'$ is a bijection β' carrying $\pi(G)$ to F'. The bijection $\beta' \circ \beta^{-1} : V_F \to V_{F'}$ carries every component of F to the corresponding component of F', so F and F' are isomorphic. □

Theorem 7.8 (Six dimensions)**.** *Relative to the same axioms and the same P, let (c, λ) be a coarsening. The abstraction Φ_c is P-preserving if and only if c is a bijection from $\mathcal{M}$ onto K. Every P-preserving coarsening Φ_c therefore has exactly $|K| = 6$ dimensions, in a bijection with $\{\mathsf{F}, \mathsf{P}, \mathsf{J}, \mathsf{I}, \mathsf{C}, \mathsf{W}\}$ that is unique up to relabeling of the dimensions, and it is isomorphic to Φ in $\mathbf{Abs}_P$.*

Proof. If c is not a bijection onto K, Proposition 7.5 gives G_1, G_2 with $\Phi_c(G_1) = \Phi_c(G_2)$ and $P(G_1) \neq P(G_2)$, so Φ_c is not P-preserving. If c is a bijection, every block is a single pillar with weight one, so $\Phi_c(G)$ is $\pi(G)$ with its pillar labels renamed by c, up to relabeling of actors; $\Phi_c(G) = \Phi_c(G')$ holds exactly when $\Phi(G) = \Phi(G')$, so Φ_c is P-preserving, and the renaming is a bijection h with $h \circ \Phi = \Phi_c$, an isomorphism in $\mathbf{Abs}_P$. A bijection from a six-element set onto K forces $|K| = 6$. Two such bijections c, c' differ by the bijection $c' \circ c^{-1}$ of K, which is a relabeling of the dimensions. □

Remark 7.9 (Scope of uniqueness)*.* Uniqueness is the universal property of Theorem 7.7 together with the count of Theorem 7.8. Both are relative to the axioms and to the preserved property set P. A different choice of P, for instance one that also kept the content of legitimating beliefs, would yield a different abstraction, which would again be unique for its own P by the same argument. Theorem 7.8 concerns coarsenings, whose blocks aggregate pillar data with the weights λ; an abstraction that groups pillars but keeps each pillar's components separately is Φ relabeled and is not a coarsening; an abstraction that splits a class, such as coercion into policing and war making, is P-preserving and factors through Φ by Theorem 7.7(b), so it is finer and not minimal.

The universal property is close to the definition of P, and that is its point: once the properties to be preserved are fixed, the coarsest abstraction preserving them is determined up to unique isomorphism. The substantive content lies elsewhere. Theorem 7.4 shows that the coarsest abstraction lands in the class $\mathcal{F}$ of six-layer structures with an interdependent dependency hypergraph, which requires necessity, and Theorem 7.8 shows that its six dimensions cannot be reduced or merged, which requires the explicit witnesses of Proposition 7.5.

8 Capture tendencies and checks

8.1 Conditional capture axioms

Capture is contingent, but it is not random. Three mechanisms recur in the literature on oligarchy and rent seeking, and each can be stated as a conditional axiom.

Assumption 8.1 (T1, delegation)**.** In an organization that holds control in some pillar, a leadership extracts a rent, and members can monitor it only at private cost, as in Assumption 6.1 of Part II.

Under T1, Proposition 6.2 of Part II shows that monitoring by members vanishes once the organization is large enough, so the leadership is never replaced, while an organized opposition faction that monitors replaces it with a probability that does not depend on size. This is the mechanism behind Michels's iron law of oligarchy (Michels, 1915), and its exceptions are the cases in which an organized opposition survived: the internal party system of the typographers' union that Lipset et al. (1956) studied, and the revitalized unions in which Voss and Sherman (2000) found the iron law broken. Cassinelli (1953) had already argued that the law is a tendency with conditions rather than a law.

Assumption 8.2 (T2, organization asymmetry)**.** Coalitions with concentrated stakes organize at lower cost per member than coalitions with diffuse stakes, so their rate of converting control in one pillar into control in another is higher.

T2 is the logic of collective action of Olson (1965) applied across pillars, and the economic theory of regulation of Stigler (1971) applied to rule making. Mosca's observation that an organized minority prevails over an unorganized majority is an older statement of the same asymmetry (Mosca, 1939).

Assumption 8.3 (T3, conversion against contestability)**.** A coalition's control in pillar m converts into control in pillar n at a rate $\eta_{nm}(1 - Q_n)$ with $\eta_{nm} \geq 0$, so contestability in the target pillar blocks conversion in proportion.

For $m = \mathsf{F}$ the empirical counterpart of η_{nm} is the conversion elasticity of Definition 6.1 of Part I. Walzer called the conversion of dominance in one sphere into dominance in another the defining mark of tyranny (Walzer, 1983), and T3 states the condition under which conversion is checked: the source's second proposition, that independent review and voice interrupt transmission (Largo, 2026).

8.2 Conversion dynamics

Definition 8.4 (Conversion dynamics)**.** Fix a coalition S and let $y_t \in [0,1]^M$ collect its control shares $y_{m,t} = \kappa_m(S)$ at date t. Let $\delta \in [0,1]^M$ be the rates at which the coalition loses control in each pillar through replacement, turnover or exit, and let $K \geq 0$ be an $M \times M$ matrix with zero diagonal, row sums at most one, and entries $K_{nm} = \eta_{nm}(1 - Q_n)$. The coalition's shares follow

$$y_{n,t+1} = (1 - \delta_n)\, y_{n,t} + (1 - y_{n,t})\, (K y_t)_n.$$

Write $A = \operatorname{diag}(1-\delta) + K$ and $\mathcal{I}(S)_t = \frac{1}{15} \sum_{m<n} \min\{y_{m,t}, y_{n,t}\}$, the coalition's contribution to integration, which is a lower bound on $\mathcal{I}_t$ by Definition 6.1.

Theorem 8.5 (Closure and reversibility)**.** *Under Definition 8.4:*

(a) the dynamics map $[0,1]^M$ into itself, and $y_{t+1} \leq A y_t$ componentwise;

(b) if the spectral radius satisfies $\rho(A) < 1$, then $y_t \to 0$ and $\mathcal{I}(S)_t \to 0$ geometrically from every initial state, so every foothold of the coalition is reversible;

(c) if $Q_n = 1$ and $\delta_n > 0$ for some pillar n, then $y_{n,t} = (1 - \delta_n)^t y_{n,0}$, every pair containing n contributes nothing in the limit, and $\limsup_t \mathcal{I}(S)_t \leq 10/15$;

(d) if $\delta_n = 0$ for some pillar n, then $y_{n,t}$ is nondecreasing, so a foothold in n never decays, and $\rho(A) \geq 1$;

(e) $\rho(A)$ is nonincreasing in each Q_n;

(f) if K is irreducible, $\max_n \delta_n < 1$ and $\rho(A) > 1$, let $v > 0$ be the left Perron vector of A, $\bar{\kappa}$ the largest column sum of K, and $c = \bar{\kappa} \max_n v_n / (\min_n v_n)^2$. Then for every $y_0 \neq 0$ and every t,

$$v^\top y_t \;\geq\; \min\Big\{ v^\top y_0,\; (1 - \max_n \delta_n) \frac{\rho(A) - 1}{2c} \Big\} > 0,$$

so the coalition's foothold never vanishes.

Proof. (a) If $y \in [0,1]^M$ then $(Ky)_n \in [0,1]$ because $K \geq 0$ has row sums at most one. Hence $y_{n,t+1} \geq 0$, and $y_{n,t+1} \leq (1-\delta_n)y_{n,t} + 1 - y_{n,t} = 1 - \delta_n y_{n,t} \leq 1$. Since $1 - y_{n,t} \leq 1$ and $(Ky_t)_n \geq 0$, $y_{n,t+1} \leq (1-\delta_n)y_{n,t} + (Ky_t)_n = (Ay_t)_n$.

(b) $A \geq 0$, so $z \leq z'$ implies $Az \leq Az'$, and induction on (a) gives $0 \leq y_t \leq A^t y_0$. When $\rho(A) < 1$, for any $r \in (\rho(A), 1)$ there is a constant b with $\|A^t\| \leq br^t$ for all t, so $y_t \to 0$ geometrically, and $\mathcal{I}(S)_t \leq \max_m y_{m,t}$ does too.

(c) $Q_n = 1$ makes row n of K zero, so $y_{n,t+1} = (1-\delta_n)y_{n,t}$. Each of the five pairs containing n contributes at most $y_{n,t} \to 0$, and the other ten contribute at most one each.

(d) With $\delta_n = 0$, $y_{n,t+1} - y_{n,t} = (1 - y_{n,t})(Ky_t)_n \geq 0$. Since $A \geq \operatorname{diag}(1-\delta) \geq 0$ entrywise and the spectral radius is monotone on nonnegative matrices (Horn and Johnson, 2012), $\rho(A) \geq \max_n(1-\delta_n) = 1$.

(e) Raising Q_n lowers or leaves unchanged every entry of row n of K, hence of A, and monotonicity of the spectral radius applies.

(f) By the Perron-Frobenius theorem for irreducible nonnegative matrices (Horn and Johnson, 2012), $\rho = \rho(A)$ has a left eigenvector v with positive entries. Write $V_t = v^\top y_t$, which is positive when $y_t \neq 0$. From the dynamics,

$$V_{t+1} = v^\top A y_t - \sum_n v_n y_{n,t}(Ky_t)_n = \rho V_t - \sum_n v_n y_{n,t}(Ky_t)_n.$$

The subtracted sum is at most $\max_n v_n \cdot \max_n y_{n,t} \cdot \sum_n (Ky_t)_n \leq \max_n v_n \cdot \|y_t\|_1 \cdot \bar{\kappa}\|y_t\|_1$, and $\|y_t\|_1 \leq V_t / \min_n v_n$, so it is at most cV_t^2. Irreducibility with $M \geq 2$ gives $K \neq 0$, so $c > 0$. Let $\varepsilon = (\rho - 1)/(2c)$. If $V_t \leq \varepsilon$ then $V_{t+1} \geq V_t(\rho - cV_t) \geq V_t(\rho + 1)/2 \geq V_t$. In every case $V_{t+1} \geq v^\top \operatorname{diag}(1-\delta) y_t \geq (1 - \max_n \delta_n)V_t$, because the term $(1 - y_t) \circ Ky_t$ is nonnegative. Let μ be the right side of the displayed bound and suppose $V_t \geq \mu$. If $V_t \leq \varepsilon$ then $V_{t+1} \geq V_t \geq \mu$; if $V_t > \varepsilon$ then $V_{t+1} \geq (1 - \max_n \delta_n)\varepsilon \geq \mu$. Since $V_0 \geq \mu$, induction gives $V_t \geq \mu$ for all t. □

The theorem gives the source's vocabulary of closure and reversibility a precise meaning. Capture is reversible when the replacement rates outrun the conversion rates in the sense that $\rho(A) < 1$, and closed when conversion along a strongly connected set of channels outruns replacement. Part (c) is a formal version of the source's second proposition: full contestability in one pillar with any positive replacement rate in it caps a coalition's integration at two thirds, whatever happens in the other five. Part (d) states the cost of entrenchment: a pillar in which the coalition cannot be replaced holds every foothold it gains.

Corollary 8.6 (Oligarchy and replacement)**.** *Under T1, if the organization that holds the coalition's control in pillar n is larger than the threshold of Proposition 6.2(a) of Part II and faces no organized opposition, then its leadership is never replaced, $\delta_n = 0$ for the leadership's control, and by Theorem 8.5(d) its foothold in n never decays. An organized opposition faction that monitors, as in Proposition 6.2(b) of Part II, makes the replacement probability positive and independent of size. Reversibility in the sense of Theorem 8.5(b) requires a positive replacement rate in every pillar.*

Proof. The first two statements are Proposition 6.2 of Part II read as statements about δ_n. The last follows from Theorem 8.5(d): if $\delta_n = 0$ then $y_{n,t} \geq y_{n,0}$ for all t, so $y_t \not\to 0$ from any initial state with $y_{n,0} > 0$. □

The corollary connects the oldest theory of capture with the checks that interrupt it. Organized opposition, contested elections, term limits, judicial tenure that does not depend

on the coalition, and the exit of members all raise replacement rates. Disclosure, independent review, open entry and protected speech raise contestability and lower conversion rates. The first family acts on the diagonal of A and the second on its off-diagonal entries. Neither family alone guarantees reversibility, and by part (c) a single pillar that has both caps integration.

8.3 Pillar-capacity dynamics

The source's aggregate dynamics $x_{t+1} = B_t x_t + D_t z_t + \varepsilon_t$ describe capacities rather than coalition shares, and the source warns that stability cannot be read off positive links (Largo, 2026). Interdependence says something about the shape of the dominant mode, and nothing about its size.

Proposition 8.7 (Common mode under interdependence)**.** *Let $B_t = B \geq 0$ for all t, and suppose $B_{mn} > 0$ whenever $n \to m$ is an arc of the underlying digraph of $\mathcal{D}^*$. Under the hypotheses of Theorem 5.10, B is irreducible, and $\rho(B)$ is a simple eigenvalue of B with an eigenvector u whose entries are all positive. If, in addition, some diagonal entry of B is positive, then with $D_t z_t + \varepsilon_t = 0$ and w the positive left eigenvector normalized by $w^\top u = 1$, $\rho(B)^{-t} x_t \to u\, w^\top x_0$ for every x_0.*

Proof. A nonnegative matrix is irreducible if and only if the digraph of its positive entries is strongly connected, and that digraph contains the underlying digraph of $\mathcal{D}^*$, which is strongly connected by Theorem 5.10. The Perron-Frobenius theorem gives the simple eigenvalue and positive eigenvector. An irreducible nonnegative matrix with a positive diagonal entry is primitive, and for primitive matrices $(B/\rho(B))^t \to uw^\top$ (Horn and Johnson, 2012). □

Under interdependence and positive linear dependencies, no pillar's capacity can grow indefinitely faster than the others: all six share one long-run rate and one profile u. The proposition says nothing about whether that rate exceeds one, and its hypothesis of nonnegative dependencies is exactly what the source doubts.

Remark 8.8 (Positive links do not settle stability). Matrices with the same positive entries can have spectral radii on opposite sides of one. The circulant matrices with first rows $(0.6, 0.45, 0)$ and $(0.6, 0.45, -0.45)$ share their positive entries; their eigenvalues are $a + b\omega^k + c\omega^{2k}$ with $\omega = e^{2\pi i/3}$, which gives spectral radius 1.05 for the first and $|0.6 \pm 0.45\, i\sqrt{3}| = \sqrt{0.9675} \approx 0.984$ for the second. The negative entries are feedback of the kind the source lists, such as legitimacy lost through coercion, and a model that records only who depends on whom cannot tell a self-reinforcing hierarchy from a self-correcting one.

8.4 Testable implications

Table 4 states the hypotheses at the level of this Part, each with the source hypothesis it refines and an observation that would refute it. The comparative evidence of Parts I to VI is qualitative and drawn from the historical record; each hypothesis states the quantitative test that would confirm or refute it. The hypotheses inherit the source's six, H1 to H6, and add two that only the series can state: that the role map is complete in every coded polity (A1, a test of the representation theorem) and that its completeness is unrelated to the indices of capture (A2).

Table 4: Hypotheses at the level of the series, with the source hypothesis each refines and a falsifier. Codings must be preregistered and include negative cases.

	Hypothesis	Parent	Falsifier
A1	No persistent collective in the record lacks any of the six functions in some form	None	A documented persistent collective without one function
A2	The six functions are realized in every coded polity while U_t and $\mathcal{I}_t$ vary widely	Proposition 1	Indices that are collinear with features of the role map
B1	Preferential rules survive adverse disclosure longer where $\mathcal{I}_t$ is high	H2	No difference in survival after disclosure
B2	Raising contestability in one pillar lowers transmission through it	H1, H4	Staggered reforms with no change in transmission
B3	Dispersing control in one pillar without reducing cross-pillar overlap leaves preferential rules intact	H2	Dispersal alone ends preferential rules
B4	Organizations without organized opposition keep their leaderships longer	H1	Equal leadership turnover with and without opposition
B5	U_t and service quality are not monotonically related	H6	A monotone decline of service quality in U_t

9 Regime profiles

9.1 The profile of a regime type

The six regime types are implementations of the Formalized State. Every one is represented by a structure in $\mathcal{F}$ (Theorem 7.4), so a comparison cannot ask whether a type has the structure; it asks how the structure is implemented. A *regime profile* records the pattern of integration, either a star around a hub pillar or a clique commanded by one coalition (Lemma 6.2); the characteristic control path, the direction in which control is converted (source Proposition 3); the checks that raise replacement rates or contestability (Theorem 8.5); and documented episodes of capture and of binding checks. The profiles synthesize the comparative sections of Parts I to VI. They are hypotheses about where a preregistered coding would find integration, not coded values.

9.2 Market capitalism

Private owners, banks and corporations hold the resource pillar alongside a public budget and a central bank (Part I, Section 5). The hypothesized pattern is a star around F: resources couple to rule making through donations and lobbying, to legitimation through media ownership and research sponsorship, to interpretation through repeat-player advantages, and to production because capital allocation and employment are held by the same actors (Parts I, II, III and VI, Section 5). The control path runs from wealth to rules (Largo, 2026). Competing firms and sectors make different coalitions on different spokes likely, the pluralist reading (Dahl, 1961), and by Lemma 6.2(b) a pure star cannot raise $\mathcal{I}_t$ above one third of its largest coupling. Documented checks include competing interest groups, antitrust, disclosure and elections (Part II, Section 5), and a recusal ruling of the United States Supreme Court that addressed a capture risk created by campaign spending in a judicial election (Part III,

Section 5).

9.3 Communist party-states

The ruling party appoints office holders in every pillar through nomenklatura lists, which the partisan émigré account of Voslensky (1984) treated as the basis of a ruling class. Rule making is the hub, and the control path runs from appointment to allocation and enforcement, the reverse of the market path (Largo, 2026). Because one coalition appoints in five pillars, the pattern is a clique: Proposition 6.5 of Part II bounds each coupling below, and Lemma 6.2(c) bounds $\mathcal{I}_t$ below by two thirds of the party's smallest command share across the five pillars. The checks lie inside the coalition, in elite divisions (Lane and Ross, 1995) and bureaucratic bargaining (Hough and Fainsod, 1979). Documented episodes include courts that followed campaign directives under Stalin and the terror of the late 1930s, and, as checks, party supremacy over the military and a later rise in legality in ordinary cases (Parts III and V, Section 5).

9.4 Social democracy and democratic socialism

The hypothesized pattern is a triangle of rule making, resources and production, joined by bargaining among the peak organizations of labor and capital and the state (Parts I, II and VI, Section 5). At least two coalitions, labor and capital, each command part of each pillar, so the overlap measure gives moderate couplings even where bargaining is encompassing. Contestability is high: governments alternate, unions give workers voice, and transparency norms are strong. The documented risk is closure to unorganized interests (Part II, Section 5). The *Langborger* ruling held that labor courts whose lay members are nominated by interested organizations can fail the test of impartiality (Part III, Section 5), and official inquiries into political surveillance by security services led to standing parliamentary oversight (Part V, Section 5). The source's fourth proposition, that public benefit is compatible with hierarchy, applies here with particular force (Largo, 2026).

9.5 Islamic states

Islamic states derive legitimacy from religious law, and classical caliphates, the Ottoman empire, modern Iran and Saudi Arabia differ in almost every coupling (Parts II, III and IV, Section 5). In Hallaq's account of classical practice, rulers appointed qadis while jurists who were not state officials developed the law (Hallaq, 2009), which kept much of J and I outside the ruler's coalition. Why the Middle East fell behind Western Europe economically is disputed: Kuran (2011) points to features of Islamic law, and Rubin (2017) to the bargains through which religious authorities legitimated rulers. The Ottoman empire governed through brokerage among several coalitions (Barkey, 2008). Modern Iran shows a clique around clerical authority: the Guardian Council screens legislation and candidates, and the revolutionary guards couple coercion to resources (Parts I, II and V, Section 5). Saudi Arabia couples rule making to legitimation through the alliance of the royal family and the religious establishment, and to resources through oil rents (Part I, Section 5; Ross 2012). The checks include juristic pluralism, endowed revenue, elections in Iran and brokered rule. Capture varies with the state and the period, not with the religion.

9.6 Historical Catholic monarchies

Habsburg Spain, Bourbon France and the Papal States intertwined royal authority with the Church, and their diversity matches that of the Islamic cases. The hypothesized pattern couples rule making to legitimation through royal influence over Church appointments, resources to interpretation through venal judicial office, and resources to coercion through the fiscal-military state (Parts I, II, III and V, Section 5; Tilly 1990; Ertman 1997). In the Papal States the fusion of rule making and legitimation was complete (Part IV, Section 5). Brokerage limited the crown: Beik describes absolutism in Languedoc as collaboration with provincial elites rather than command (Beik, 1985). Checks included the estates and Cortes, competing jurisdictions and conflict between Church and crown. The chancellor Maupeou's suppression of the parlements in 1771 removed a check, and its reversal in 1774 restored it (Part III, Section 5). In the terms of Theorem 8.5, venality raised the conversion rate from F to J, while the parlements' tenure kept the replacement rate in J out of the crown's hands.

9.7 Secular democracies

Authority is distributed among elected officials, courts and private institutions, and contestability is designed to be high on every component (Parts II and V, Section 5). Couplings are low overall, with two characteristic channels: appointments to courts, with constitutional review that can act as co-legislation (Hirschl, 2004), and delegation to independent central banks, regulators and courts whose accountability runs through review rather than election (Parts I and III, Section 5). The documented risks are erosion of contestability by incumbents and capture of the bodies that review them: the enlargement of the Argentine Supreme Court in 1990 produced a court aligned with the government (Part III, Section 5), and surveillance of citizens exposed by the United States Senate inquiry of 1975 and 1976 was both a capture episode and a check (Part V, Section 5). Rival institutions, a free press and citizens' coordination against transgressions by the state, which Weingast (1997) identified as the foundation of self-enforcing limits on government, are the checks.

9.8 What the classification shows

Table 5 summarizes the profiles. Every row satisfies Struct and Inter and has the same dependency structure, because that structure is a function of the problems a collective faces, not of who solves them (Lemma 6.5). The rows differ in the pattern of integration, and the star and clique bounds of Lemma 6.2 explain why market and party-state profiles with similar maximal couplings can differ sharply in $\mathcal{I}_t$. Every row records both capture episodes and binding checks, so the regime type does not settle whether a polity is captured; that requires coding a polity in a period, with preregistered weights, thresholds and coalition lists.

10 Predecessors and novelty

10.1 The canon

Earlier answers to the question of what every polity must contain are of three kinds: typologies of rulers and of legitimacy, lists of functions, and derivations from premises. The typologies classify polities along axes other than the six functions. Aristotle classified constitutions by whether one, a few or many rule and whether they rule for the common

Table 5: Regime profiles. Patterns and paths are drawn from the comparative sections of Parts I to VI.

Regime type	Hypothesized integration pattern	Characteristic control path	Principal checks
Market capitalism	A star around resources, with different coalitions on different spokes	From wealth to rules, legitimation and interpretation	Competition among interests, antitrust, disclosure, elections and courts
Communist party-state	A clique of five pillars under the ruling party	From appointment to allocation and enforcement	Elite divisions, bureaucratic bargaining and the loyalty limit on appointment
Social democracy	A triangle of rule making, resources and production joined by bargaining	From organized bargaining to rules and terms of work	Elections, organized labor, ombudsmen and parliamentary oversight
Islamic states	Plural in classical practice and a clique around clerical authority in modern Iran	From religious-legal authority to rules and adjudication, and from rents to rule	Juristic pluralism, endowed revenue, brokerage and elections in Iran
Catholic monarchies	Couplings of crown and Church, of money and justice, and of money and force	From fiscal need to venal office and from Church patronage to legitimation	Parlements, estates and Cortes, competing jurisdictions and Church-crown conflict
Secular democracies	Low couplings, with appointment to courts and delegation to technical bodies	From rule making to interpretation through appointment	Rival institutions, free press, review bodies and citizen coordination

interest or their own, and distinguished the deliberative, magisterial and judicial elements of a constitution (Aristotle, 1996). Weber classified domination by the belief in its legitimacy, traditional, charismatic or legal-rational, and by the administrative staff that executes it (Weber, 1978).

The lists of functions are the closest relatives. Parsons named four functional prerequisites of any social system, adaptation, goal attainment, integration and latent pattern maintenance (Parsons, 1951), and Aberle et al. (1950) gave a longer list. Easton described the political system as converting inputs of demands and supports into authoritative outputs (Easton, 1965). Almond divided political functions into input functions, among them socialization, interest articulation, interest aggregation and communication, and output functions, rule making, rule application and rule adjudication (Almond and Coleman, 1960). Luhmann described modern society as differentiated into functional subsystems, among them the economy, politics, law, science, religion and the mass media (Luhmann, 1995). Mann treated societies as overlapping networks of ideological, economic, military and political power, none of them primary (Mann, 1986, 1993). These lists were criticized for defining prerequisites by what persisting societies happen to have (Hempel, 1959; Elster, 1983).

The derivations are the model for the method. Hobbes derived the sovereign from the premise that agreements without a power to enforce them do not hold (Hobbes, 1996); Part V accepts the premise and derives a sanctioning function rather than a sovereign. Arrow's impossibility theorem derives a sharp result about collective decisions from short axioms (Arrow, 1951); it concerns aggregation rather than the structure of governance, and the rule-making function of Part II begins where it leaves off, since a collective must choose some procedure although none satisfies every desirable condition.

The lists differ from the six pillars at exactly the points the formal results test. Mann's economic source and Parsons's adaptation join the command of resources with the production of wealth, which the latent veto (Proposition 3.6 of Part VI) and relocation (Lemma 3.4 of Part VI) separate; Mann's political source joins rule making with adjudication, which the disjunctive dependency of Proposition 3.6 of Part III separates. Mann's distinction between the despotic power of elites and the infrastructural power of states (Mann, 1984) corresponds to the distinction between U_t and the capacity vector x_t, and his historical account of how particular networks emerged is something no axiomatic treatment replaces.

Two further literatures address the other side of the thesis. The theory of capture, from Michels (Michels, 1915) through Stigler (Stigler, 1971), state capture (Hellman et al., 2000), extractive institutions (Acemoglu and Robinson, 2006, 2019) and limited-access orders (North et al., 2009), explains when capture arises, which is Proposition B, and does not state what every polity must contain. Normative theory supplies readings of the indices: the separation of powers of Montesquieu and Madison covers two pillars and part of a third (Montesquieu, 1989; Madison, 1788), and Walzer's spheres and Pettit's non-domination give normative content to C_{mn} and Q_m (Walzer, 1983; Pettit, 1997).

10.2 Non-equivalence

Each predecessor can be encoded as an abstraction on $\mathcal{G}_*$, and the encodings can be compared with Φ in $\mathbf{Abs}_P$. Five are coarsenings in the sense of Section 7, with equal weights within each block. Parsons: adaptation $= \{\mathsf{F}, \mathsf{W}\}$, goal attainment $= \{\mathsf{P}\}$, integration $= \{\mathsf{J}, \mathsf{C}\}$, latent pattern maintenance $= \{\mathsf{I}\}$ (Parsons, 1951); whether coercion belongs to goal attainment or to integration is contestable, and the choice does not affect the argument. Mann: ideological $= \{\mathsf{I}\}$, economic $= \{\mathsf{F}, \mathsf{W}\}$, military $= \{\mathsf{C}\}$, political $= \{\mathsf{P}, \mathsf{J}\}$ (Mann, 1986). Easton: inputs

$= \{\mathsf{I}, \mathsf{W}\}$, outputs $= \{\mathsf{F}, \mathsf{P}, \mathsf{J}, \mathsf{C}\}$ (Easton, 1965); the assignment of production to inputs, as the source of supports, is contestable. Almond: rule making $= \{\mathsf{P}\}$, rule application $= \{\mathsf{C}\}$, rule adjudication $= \{\mathsf{J}\}$, inputs $= \{\mathsf{I}\}$, with F and W dropped because his functions are those of the political system (Almond and Coleman, 1960); placing administration with coercion is contestable. Luhmann: economy $= \{\mathsf{F}, \mathsf{W}\}$, politics $= \{\mathsf{P}, \mathsf{C}\}$, law $= \{\mathsf{J}\}$, and one block for the communicative subsystems $= \{\mathsf{I}\}$ (Luhmann, 1995); Luhmann splits that block further, which the argument does not need. These encodings are readings of the 1960 and 1995 partitions: Almond and Powell later added system capabilities, among them extractive, regulative and distributive ones, that touch F (Almond and Powell, 1966), and Luhmann's subsystems are codes of communication rather than layers of actors. The other two are typologies. Aristotle's encoding returns the number of rulers, one if a single actor has a positive share of rule making, few if between two and half the members do, many otherwise, and the aim, deviant if a capture link is documented and correct otherwise (Aristotle, 1996); the thresholds are a choice. Weber's encoding returns the coded type of legitimation and whether an administrative staff exists (Weber, 1978).

Proposition 10.1 (Witnesses)**.** *For each encoding α_k above there are $G, G' \in \mathcal{G}_*$ with $\alpha_k(G) = \alpha_k(G')$ and $P(G) \neq P(G')$:*

(a) Parsons, Mann and Luhmann merge F and W, and Mann and Easton merge P and J; the pair of Proposition 7.5(b) for the merged pair, with $\mu = 1/2$, has C^{ov} equal to 0 against $1/2$ and H equal to 1 against $1/2$ in each merged pillar;

(b) Almond drops F; the pair of Proposition 7.5(a) with $m = \mathsf{F}$ and $l_0 = \mathsf{P}$ has $H_{\mathsf{F}} = 1$ against $1/2$;

(c) Aristotle: two collectives with the same rule-making layer and no capture link, in which interpretation is held by one organization ($s^{\mathsf{J}} = (1, 0)$ on (a, b), $H_{\mathsf{J}} = 1$) or by two equally ($s^{\mathsf{J}} = (1/2, 1/2)$, $H_{\mathsf{J}} = 1/2$), with a and b holding equal shares in I in both;

(d) Weber: two collectives coded as legal-rational with an administrative staff, in which coercion is held by one organization ($s^{\mathsf{C}} = (1, 0)$ on (a, b), $H_{\mathsf{C}} = 1$) or by two equally ($H_{\mathsf{C}} = 1/2$), with a and b holding equal shares in I in both.

Hence no encoded predecessor is P-preserving, and none is isomorphic to Φ in $\mathbf{Abs}_P$.

Proof. (a) and (b) are instances of Proposition 7.5, whose proof computes both P-values and shows the coarsened images equal for any weights. Easton's outputs block contains F, C and the merged pair; the coarsened shares of the block are a weighted sum in which only the P and J terms differ between the two collectives, and those terms sum to the same vector, as in the proof of Proposition 7.5(b). (c) The two collectives have the same actor set, since b performs practices of I in both. They have the same set of actors with positive rule-making share and the same empty set of capture links, so the encoding returns the same number of rulers and the same aim. Their H_{J} differ, and H_{J} is invariant under relabeling. Both assignments are admissible as in the proof of Proposition 7.5, so both lie in $\mathcal{G}_*$ by Lemma 6.5. (d) The actor sets coincide as in (c). The two collectives carry the same coded legitimation type and staff, so the encoding agrees; H_{C} differs. For the last sentence: an abstraction isomorphic to Φ has the same partition of $\mathcal{G}_*$ as Φ, which is the partition into $\cong_A$-classes, and is therefore P-preserving. □

The Weber encoding fails in the other direction too. Two collectives with the same profile can carry different legitimation types, since P forgets the content of legitimating beliefs (Lemma 7.3); so neither of Weber's typology and Φ factors through the other. Weber classifies what the Formalized State forgets, and the two are complements rather than rivals.

Theorem 10.2 (Novelty relative to the canon)**.** *For each of the encoded predecessors, Aristotle, Weber, Parsons, Easton, Almond, Luhmann and Mann, the encoding α_k is not isomorphic to Φ in $\mathbf{Abs}_P$, does not represent governance systems up to $\cong_A$, and is not the coarsest P-preserving abstraction. The Formalized State abstraction has all four properties: representation, necessity, minimality and uniqueness.*

Proof. By Proposition 10.1, each α_k identifies two systems that are not $\cong_A$-equivalent, so it does not represent systems up to $\cong_A$ and is not P-preserving. A terminal object of $\mathbf{Abs}_P$ is in particular an object of it, so α_k is neither terminal nor isomorphic to Φ. The four properties of Φ are Theorem 7.4, Theorems 4.3 and 5.10, Proposition 7.5, and Theorems 7.7 and 7.8. □

Remark 10.3 (Scope of novelty). The theorem covers the seven encoded predecessors and is relative to P: the predecessors were built to preserve other things, and failing to preserve P is a difference, not a defect. For works outside the list, the novelty claim is that, to our knowledge, no prior work states and proves a representation theorem with derived necessity, minimality and uniqueness of this form.

Table 6 summarizes the comparison. The columns record representation up to $\cong_A$ (R), necessity derived from premises that can be false (N), minimality among P-preserving coarsenings (M) and uniqueness as the coarsest P-preserving abstraction (U). For the predecessors the R, M and U entries follow from Proposition 10.1; the N entries record that none derives its list from stated axioms with falsifiers, which is a reading of the cited works rather than a theorem.

Table 6: The Formalized State and the encoded predecessors. R, N, M and U are representation, derived necessity, minimality and uniqueness; the last column names the result that gives the pair of systems the encoding cannot tell apart.

Framework	Size	Encoding	R	N	M	U	Witness
Formalized State	Six	The profile map	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	None
Parsons	Four	Merges resources and production	No	No	No	No	Proposition 10.1(a)
Mann	Four	Merges resources and production, and rule making and adjudication	No	No	No	No	Proposition 10.1(a)
Easton	Two	Merges rule making and adjudication among outputs	No	No	No	No	Proposition 10.1(a)
Almond	Seven	Drops resources and production	No	No	No	No	Proposition 10.1(b)
Luhmann	Several	Merges resources and production in the economy	No	No	No	No	Proposition 10.1(a)
Aristotle	Six types	Number of rulers and aim	No	No	No	No	Proposition 10.1(c)
Weber	Three types	Legitimation type and staff	No	No	No	No	Proposition 10.1(d)

11 Revelation 13 and 17 to 18

The series reads Revelation typologically. The beast is a recurring pattern of power that claims ultimate allegiance, and Babylon is the idolatrous city of every age. The reading does not identify any present-day government, party, institution, technology, payment system or person with the beast or its mark. Futurist identifications have a long record of failure (McGinn, 1998; Fuller, 1995; Boyer, 1992), and historicist identifications of the papacy or of any other institution with the beast belong to the history of polemic. The theological reading is the project's own and is offered as an interpretation, not as an exegetical result.

The commentators agree that the beasts had a Roman referent, which the typological reading generalizes. Richard Bauckham reads Rome as the paradigm of the beast and the book's conflict as one between worship of the beast and faithful witness (Bauckham, 1993), and he reads chapter 18 as an economic critique of Rome's trade (Bauckham, 1991). Adela Yarbro Collins reads the book as a response to a crisis its audience perceived, working through catharsis (Collins, 1984). Craig Koester's commentary places the beasts in the imperial politics and civic cults of Roman Asia (Koester, 2014). J. Nelson Kraybill shows how participation in provincial commerce was bound up with the imperial cult (Kraybill, 1996), and the archaeology of the imperial cult at Ephesus and the study of the cult as local civic practice give the image its setting (Friesen, 2001; Price, 1984).

Read with the formal model, chapter 13 describes a single configuration in all six pillars. The dragon gives the first beast "his power, and his seat, and great authority" (Rev 13:2), and the onlookers ask "Who is like unto the beast? who is able to make war with him?" (Rev 13:4): rule and force held together. The second beast "exerciseth all the power of the first beast before him, and causeth the earth and them which dwell therein to worship the first beast" (Rev 13:12): legitimation in the service of rule. It gives life to an image that causes "that as many as would not worship the image of the beast should be killed" (Rev 13:15): sanction attached to allegiance, with no forum for those who refuse. And it causes all, "both small and great, rich and poor, free and bond, to receive a mark in their right hand, or in their foreheads: And that no man might buy or sell, save he that had the mark" (Rev 13:16 and 13:17) (King James Bible, 1611): participation in exchange and production made conditional on an allegiance test. In the vocabulary of Section 6, one coalition commands every pillar, contestability is zero, and integration is complete. The image is the corner $(1, 1)$ of Theorem 6.6, with every capture link documented in the text itself.

Chapters 17 and 18 add the coalition and the market. The kings "have one mind, and shall give their power and strength unto the beast" (Rev 17:13), a coalition formed by delegation, which is the mechanism of T1. The waters on which the city sits "are peoples, and multitudes, and nations, and tongues" (Rev 17:15). The merchants "are waxed rich through the abundance of her delicacies" (Rev 18:3), they mourn because "no man buyeth their merchandise any more" (Rev 18:11), and the cargo list ends with "slaves, and souls of men" (Rev 18:13) (King James Bible, 1611). The text does not condemn commerce as such. It condemns a commerce whose merchants "were the great men of the earth" (Rev 18:23), an integration of resources and production with rule. Following the source, the series uses the language of bondage only in this disciplined and explicitly metaphorical sense, and distinguishes wage labor, taxation, serfdom and chattel slavery (Largo, 2026). The book's response is exit: "Come out of her, my people" (Rev 18:4). In Theorem 8.5, exit is a replacement rate.

The typology therefore fits the separation of the two propositions in a specific way. The text depicts the captured configuration, Proposition B at its limit, and it presupposes the

functions of Proposition A: the book does not imagine a world without rule, judgment, worship, commerce or labor, but relocates them, as Part III observed of judgment. The series names the universal abstraction after the image of its worst instance. The name is the series' typological reading of the abstraction, not a conclusion of any theorem, and the normative warning attaches only to capture, which is a property of instances. The source makes the same distinction: the expression should be reserved for coercive and unaccountable coordination, and the theological image permits government that protects the vulnerable and expertise that corrects error (Largo, 2026). Walter Wink's reading of the biblical language of the powers as institutional structures that can become a domination system is a theological precedent for reading the image as a structure rather than a person (Wink, 1992).

12 Objections and scope

Proposition A is true by definition. If the functions were defined so broadly that anything counts, the theorem would be empty. Each implementation predicate is a property of observable dispositions that can fail, and Proposition 4.4(b) exhibits persistent collectives in which each fails. The theorem excludes them from the real world only through its premises, and Table 3 states what observation would refute each premise.

The argument is functionalist. Theorem 4.3 is a condition of persistence. It explains no institution by its effects, asserts no feedback from effects to causes, and allows any institution or none to perform a function. It is open to Hempel's objection only if read as an inference from a function to a particular institution, and it makes no such inference.

The hazard premises are too strong. Where unsettled conflict or abandoned disputes are harmless, the forcing argument gives nothing. The concession is real. Part III's exit proposition shows that adjudication can be thin where exit is free, and the immediate-return foragers that Woodburn described come closest to that condition (Woodburn, 1982). The ethnographies of these societies still record talk-based mediation and leveling sanctions, so the functions are thin rather than absent, and the claim is narrowed to collectives in which some recurring class of residual disputes cannot be escaped by moving; a collective in which every residual dispute can be escaped at no cost falls outside the derivation, and Proposition 3.4 of Part III shows that such a collective can persist without determination.

Interdependence rests on added premises. It does, and Proposition 5.11(a) shows that the six axioms alone do not yield it. Universal interdependence has the same logical status as the existence of the functions: a theorem from stated premises, made universal by the hypothesis that every functioning collective satisfies them. The premises can be refuted by observation. Universal interdependence would be falsified by a persistent collective in which production continued unchanged while every claim on its inputs went unsettled, which refutes X1 and removes the only arc into production; by one whose allocation rules survived a change of environment that created claims they could not settle, which refutes X2; by one whose allocation rules never produced a dispute the parties could not settle alone, which refutes X3; or by one whose allocation rules were kept, at a measured temptation above a preregistered tolerance, after every response to breach had ceased, which refutes X5. A single such collective would leave its dependency structure without a path from some function to production, or without a cascade from coercion, and would show that interdependence is common rather than universal. Universal interdependence is also not universal capture. It holds in every corner of Theorem 6.6, including the stateless corner where no one holds more than an equal share of anything.

There is no single apex. The pluralist objection, that complex polities seldom have a unified center of command (Dahl, 1961), is an objection to Proposition B, not to Proposition A, and the framework accommodates it. A polity whose couplings form a star built by different coalitions has bounded integration by Lemma 6.2(b), and the strong classification requires a documented coalition, mechanism, domain and duration (Largo, 2026).

The indices cannot be measured. The indices are defined for measurement, and what the paper proves about them is their range, the effect of the weights (Lemma 6.4), and the bounds that link coalition structure to integration (Lemma 6.2). These results constrain measurement without performing it. The latent-variable and event-study designs of the source, together with a coding of the five conditions of a capture link, remain the agenda.

The name condemns all governance. Naming the universal structure after the beast could be read as a verdict that every polity is the beast of Revelation. The series rejects that reading. The name refers to a structure that every governance system has, and Proposition A carries no moral verdict; the warning attaches to Proposition B, and Theorem 6.6 shows that every regime type can satisfy A without B. Government that protects the vulnerable, courts that check power and expertise that corrects error are compatible with the structure and are among the checks that interrupt capture.

The abstraction forgets too much. The equivalence $\cong_A$ forgets the content of rules and beliefs, the procedures that implement each function, and the moral quality of outcomes (Lemma 7.3). A medieval monarchy and a modern republic can have the same image if their control shares, contestability, couplings and dependencies coincide. This is the price of a representation that covers every governance system, and it is why the abstraction says nothing about justice. The properties it keeps are the ones that the capture predicate needs, and the properties it forgets are left to history, law and theology.

Uniqueness is built into the definitions. The universal property of Theorem 7.7 follows quickly once the preserved properties are fixed, and Remark 7.9 says so. The substantive content is that the coarsest abstraction is a class of six-layer structures with an interdependent dependency hypergraph, which needs necessity, and that no coarsening of it works, which needs the witness pairs. A reader who wants to preserve other properties obtains another abstraction, unique for those properties.

Class relations are underdeveloped. A Marxian reader may find that the six pillars dissolve class into functions. The productive pillar is the place where the objection is met. Part VI shows that producers hold a latent veto over every institution that cannot replace their output (Proposition 3.6 of Part VI), and the dependency structure makes every function depend on production. The framework is a middle-range theory of institutions, and it leaves the theory of class formation to others.

13 Conclusion

The six-pillar framework identifies an invariant structure of human governance, supported by historical observation and given precise expression through mathematics. Relative to six axioms about collective life, four incidence axioms and a stated set of preserved properties, the Formalized State has four properties. It represents every governance system that satisfies the axioms, preserving roles, control shares, concentration, contestability, integration and dependencies and forgetting content, ideology and procedure. Its components are necessary, because the axioms force each function and each dependency and each axiom can fail in a persistent model. It is minimal, because every way of dropping or merging pillars confuses

two systems with different preserved properties. And it is unique, as the coarsest abstraction that preserves those properties, up to a unique isomorphism, with exactly six dimensions. Encodings of seven classical frameworks each confuse a pair of systems that it distinguishes.

Capture belongs to instances. Structures that satisfy every axiom occupy every corner of the concentration and integration square, so the existence of the structure settles nothing about its capture, and the conversion model shows how replacement and contestability decide whether a coalition's foothold dies out. The open questions are empirical: whether every functioning collective satisfies the axioms, which has been tested against the ethnographic and historical record only qualitatively; and the quantitative scoring of real polities on indices whose ranges are proved here. The series calls the abstraction the Hierarchy of the Beast System. The structure is universal, its capture is contingent, and the difference between them is a matter of measurement.

A Code evidence

The reference implementation is the Python package `beast_system` in the directory `model/` of the project, with its tests in `model/tests/`. It encodes the formal objects of this paper and checks the results that admit a computational check on coded fixtures.

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